

BibInVs MN 41

Mark

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 41*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Mark

Mark 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 The good news of Jesus Christ--the Message!--begins here,
- 1 The beginning of the gospel about Jesus Christ, the Son of God.
- 2 following to the letter the scroll of the prophet Isaiah. Watch closely: I'm sending my preacher ahead of you; He'll make the road smooth for you.
- 2 It is written in Isaiah the prophet: "I will send my messenger ahead of you, who will prepare your way" --
- 3 Thunder in the desert! Prepare for God's arrival! Make the road smooth and straight!
- 3 a voice of one calling in the desert, 'Prepare the way for the Lord, make straight paths for him.'
- 4 John the Baptizer appeared in the wild, preaching a baptism of life-change that leads to forgiveness of sins.
- 4 And so John came, baptizing in the desert region and preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.
- 5 People thronged to him from Judea and Jerusalem and, as they confessed their sins, were baptized by him in the Jordan River into a changed life.
- 5 The whole Judean countryside and all the people of Jerusalem went out to him. Confessing their sins, they were baptized by him in the Jordan River.
- 6 John wore a camel-hair habit, tied at the waist with a leather belt. He ate locusts and wild field honey.
- 6 John wore clothing made of camel's hair, with a leather belt around his waist, and he ate locusts and wild honey.
- 7 As he preached he said, "The real action comes next: The star in this drama, to whom I'm a mere stagehand, will change your life.
- 7 And this was his message: "After me will come one more powerful than I, the thongs of whose sandals I am not worthy to stoop down and untie.

- 8 I'm baptizing you here in the river, turning your old life in for a kingdom life. His baptism--a holy baptism by the Holy Spirit--will change you from the inside out."
- 8 I baptize you with water, but he will baptize you with the Holy Spirit."
- 9 At this time, Jesus came from Nazareth in Galilee and was baptized by John in the Jordan.
- 9 At that time Jesus came from Nazareth in Galilee and was baptized by John in the Jordan.
- 10 The moment he came out of the water, he saw the sky split open and God's Spirit, looking like a dove, come down on him.
- 10 As Jesus was coming up out of the water, he saw heaven being torn open and the Spirit descending on him like a dove.
- 11 Along with the Spirit, a voice: "You are my Son, chosen and marked by my love, pride of my life."
- 11 And a voice came from heaven: "You are my Son, whom I love; with you I am well pleased."
- 12 At once, this same Spirit pushed Jesus out into the wild.
- 12 At once the Spirit sent him out into the desert,
- 13 For forty wilderness days and nights he was tested by Satan. Wild animals were his companions, and angels took care of him.
- 13 and he was in the desert forty days, being tempted by Satan. He was with the wild animals, and angels attended him.
- 14 After John was arrested, Jesus went to Galilee preaching the Message of God:
- 14 After John was put in prison, Jesus went into Galilee, proclaiming the good news of God.
- 15 "Time's up! God's kingdom is here. Change your life and believe the Message."
- 15 The time has come, he said. "The kingdom of God is near. Repent and believe the good news!"
- 16 Passing along the beach of Lake Galilee, he saw Simon and his brother Andrew net-fishing. Fishing was their regular work.
- 16 As Jesus walked beside the Sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and his brother Andrew casting a net into the lake, for they were fishermen.
- 17 Jesus said to them, "Come with me. I'll make a new kind of fisherman out of you. I'll show you how to catch men and women instead of perch

and bass."

17 Come, follow me, Jesus said, "and I will make you fishers of men."

18 They didn't ask questions. They dropped their nets and followed.

18 At once they left their nets and followed him.

19 A dozen yards or so down the beach, he saw the brothers James and John, Zebedee's sons. They were in the boat, mending their fishnets.

19 When he had gone a little farther, he saw James son of Zebedee and his brother John in a boat, preparing their nets.

20 Right off, he made the same offer. Immediately, they left their father Zebedee, the boat, and the hired hands, and followed.

20 Without delay he called them, and they left their father Zebedee in the boat with the hired men and followed him.

21 Then they entered Capernaum. When the Sabbath arrived, Jesus lost no time in getting to the meeting place. He spent the day there teaching.

21 They went to Capernaum, and when the Sabbath came, Jesus went into the synagogue and began to teach.

22 They were surprised at his teaching--so forthright, so confident--not quibbling and quoting like the religion scholars.

22 The people were amazed at his teaching, because he taught them as one who had authority, not as the teachers of the law.

23 Suddenly, while still in the meeting place, he was interrupted by a man who was deeply disturbed and yelling out,

23 Just then a man in their synagogue who was possessed by an evil spirit cried out,

24 "What business do you have here with us, Jesus? Nazarene! I know what you're up to! You're the Holy One of God, and you've come to destroy us!"

24 What do you want with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have you come to destroy us? I know who you are--the Holy One of God!

25 Jesus shut him up: "Quiet! Get out of him!"

25 Be quiet! said Jesus sternly. "Come out of him!"

26 The afflicting spirit threw the man into spasms, protesting loudly--and got out.

26 The evil spirit shook the man violently and came out of him with a shriek.

27 Everyone there was incredulous, buzzing with curiosity. "What's going on here? A new teaching that does what it says? He shuts up defiling, demonic spirits and sends them packing!"

27 The people were all so amazed that they asked each other, "What is this? A new teaching--and with authority! He even gives orders to evil spirits and they obey him."

28 News of this traveled fast and was soon all over Galilee.

28 News about him spread quickly over the whole region of Galilee.

29 Directly on leaving the meeting place, they came to Simon and Andrew's house, accompanied by James and John.

29 As soon as they left the synagogue, they went with James and John to the home of Simon and Andrew.

30 Simon's mother-in-law was sick in bed, burning up with fever. They told Jesus.

30 Simon's mother-in-law was in bed with a fever, and they told Jesus about her.

31 He went to her, took her hand, and raised her up. No sooner had the fever left than she was up fixing dinner for them.

31 So he went to her, took her hand and helped her up. The fever left her and she began to wait on them.

32 That evening, after the sun was down, they brought sick and evil-afflicted people to him,

32 That evening after sunset the people brought to Jesus all the sick and demon-possessed.

33 the whole city lined up at his door!

33 The whole town gathered at the door,

34 He cured their sick bodies and tormented spirits. Because the demons knew his true identity, he didn't let them say a word.

34 and Jesus healed many who had various diseases. He also drove out many demons, but he would not let the demons speak because they knew who he was.

35 While it was still night, way before dawn, he got up and went out to a secluded spot and prayed.

35 Very early in the morning, while it was still dark, Jesus got up, left the house and went off to a solitary place, where he prayed.

36 Simon and those with him went looking for him.

36 Simon and his companions went to look for him,
37 They found him and said, "Everybody's looking for you."
37 and when they found him, they exclaimed: "Everyone is looking for you!"
38 Jesus said, "Let's go to the rest of the villages so I can preach there also. This is why I've come."
38 Jesus replied, "Let us go somewhere else--to the nearby villages--so I can preach there also. That is why I have come."
39 He went to their meeting places all through Galilee, preaching and throwing out the demons.
39 So he traveled throughout Galilee, preaching in their synagogues and driving out demons.
40 A leper came to him, begging on his knees, "If you want to, you can cleanse me."
40 A man with leprosy came to him and begged him on his knees, "If you are willing, you can make me clean."
41 Deeply moved, Jesus put out his hand, touched him, and said, "I want to. Be clean."
41 Filled with compassion, Jesus reached out his hand and touched the man. "I am willing," he said. "Be clean!"
42 Then and there the leprosy was gone, his skin smooth and healthy.
42 Immediately the leprosy left him and he was cured.
43 Jesus dismissed him with strict orders:
43 Jesus sent him away at once with a strong warning:
44 "Say nothing to anyone. Take the offering for cleansing that Moses prescribed and present yourself to the priest. This will validate your healing to the people."
44 See that you don't tell this to anyone. But go, show yourself to the priest and offer the sacrifices that Moses commanded for your cleansing, as a testimony to them.
45 But as soon as the man was out of earshot, he told everyone he met what had happened, spreading the news all over town. So Jesus kept to out-of-the-way places, no longer able to move freely in and out of the city. But people found him, and came from all over.
45 Instead he went out and began to talk freely, spreading the news. As a result, Jesus could no longer enter a town openly but stayed outside in

lonely places. Yet the people still came to him from everywhere.

Mark 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 After a few days, Jesus returned to Capernaum, and word got around that he was back home.
- 1 A few days later, when Jesus again entered Capernaum, the people heard that he had come home.
- 2 A crowd gathered, jamming the entrance so no one could get in or out. He was teaching the Word.
- 2 So many gathered that there was no room left, not even outside the door, and he preached the word to them.
- 3 They brought a paraplegic to him, carried by four men.
- 3 Some men came, bringing to him a paralytic, carried by four of them.
- 4 When they weren't able to get in because of the crowd, they removed part of the roof and lowered the paraplegic on his stretcher.
- 4 Since they could not get him to Jesus because of the crowd, they made an opening in the roof above Jesus and, after digging through it, lowered the mat the paralyzed man was lying on.
- 5 Impressed by their bold belief, Jesus said to the paraplegic, "Son, I forgive your sins."
- 5 When Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralytic, "Son, your sins are forgiven."
- 6 Some religion scholars sitting there started whispering among themselves,
- 6 Now some teachers of the law were sitting there, thinking to themselves,
- 7 "He can't talk that way! That's blasphemy! God and only God can forgive sins."
- 7 Why does this fellow talk like that? He's blaspheming! Who can forgive sins but God alone?
- 8 Jesus knew right away what they were thinking, and said, "Why are you so skeptical?
- 8 Immediately Jesus knew in his spirit that this was what they were thinking in their hearts, and he said to them, "Why are you thinking these

things?

- 9 Which is simpler: to say to the paraplegic, 'I forgive your sins,' or say, 'Get up, take your stretcher, and start walking'?
- 9 Which is easier: to say to the paralytic, 'Your sins are forgiven,' or to say, 'Get up, take your mat and walk'?
- 10 Well, just so it's clear that I'm the Son of Man and authorized to do either, or both . . ." (he looked now at the paraplegic),
- 10 But that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins" He said to the paralytic,
- 11 "Get up. Pick up your stretcher and go home."
- 11 I tell you, get up, take your mat and go home.
- 12 And the man did it--got up, grabbed his stretcher, and walked out, with everyone there watching him. They rubbed their eyes, incredulous--and then praised God, saying, "We've never seen anything like this!"
- 12 He got up, took his mat and walked out in full view of them all. This amazed everyone and they praised God, saying, "We have never seen anything like this!"
- 13 Then Jesus went again to walk alongside the lake. Again a crowd came to him, and he taught them.
- 13 Once again Jesus went out beside the lake. A large crowd came to him, and he began to teach them.
- 14 Strolling along, he saw Levi, son of Alphaeus, at his work collecting taxes. Jesus said, "Come along with me." He came.
- 14 As he walked along, he saw Levi son of Alphaeus sitting at the tax collector's booth. "Follow me," Jesus told him, and Levi got up and followed him.
- 15 Later Jesus and his disciples were at home having supper with a collection of disreputable guests. Unlikely as it seems, more than a few of them had become followers.
- 15 While Jesus was having dinner at Levi's house, many tax collectors and "sinners" were eating with him and his disciples, for there were many who followed him.
- 16 The religion scholars and Pharisees saw him keeping this kind of company and lit into his disciples: "What kind of example is this, acting cozy with the riff-raff?"

- 16 When the teachers of the law who were Pharisees saw him eating with the "sinners" and tax collectors, they asked his disciples: "Why does he eat with tax collectors and 'sinners'?"
- 17 Jesus, overhearing, shot back, "Who needs a doctor: the healthy or the sick? I'm here inviting the sin-sick, not the spiritually-fit."
- 17 On hearing this, Jesus said to them, "It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick. I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners."
- 18 The disciples of John and the disciples of the Pharisees made a practice of fasting. Some people confronted Jesus: "Why do the followers of John and the Pharisees take on the discipline of fasting, but your followers don't?"
- 18 Now John's disciples and the Pharisees were fasting. Some people came and asked Jesus, "How is it that John's disciples and the disciples of the Pharisees are fasting, but yours are not?"
- 19 Jesus said, "When you're celebrating a wedding, you don't skimp on the cake and wine. You feast. Later you may need to pull in your belt, but not now. As long as the bride and groom are with you, you have a good time. No one throws cold water on a friendly bonfire. This is Kingdom Come!"
- 19 Jesus answered, "How can the guests of the bridegroom fast while he is with them? They cannot, so long as they have him with them."
- 20 (SEE 2:19)
- 20 But the time will come when the bridegroom will be taken from them, and on that day they will fast.
- 21 He went on, "No one cuts up a fine silk scarf to patch old work clothes; you want fabrics that match.
- 21 No one sews a patch of unshrunk cloth on an old garment. If he does, the new piece will pull away from the old, making the tear worse.
- 22 And you don't put your wine in cracked bottles."
- 22 And no one pours new wine into old wineskins. If he does, the wine will burst the skins, and both the wine and the wineskins will be ruined. No, he pours new wine into new wineskins."
- 23 One Sabbath day he was walking through a field of ripe grain.
- 23 One Sabbath Jesus was going through the grainfields, and as his disciples walked along, they began to pick some heads of grain.

- 24 As his disciples made a path, they pulled off heads of grain. The Pharisees told on them to Jesus: "Look, your disciples are breaking Sabbath rules!"
- 24 The Pharisees said to him, "Look, why are they doing what is unlawful on the Sabbath?"
- 25 Jesus said, "Really? Haven't you ever read what David did when he was hungry, along with those who were with him?"
- 25 He answered, "Have you never read what David did when he and his companions were hungry and in need?"
- 26 How he entered the sanctuary and ate fresh bread off the altar, with the Chief Priest Abiathar right there watching--holy bread that no one but priests were allowed to eat--and handed it out to his companions?"
- 26 In the days of Abiathar the high priest, he entered the house of God and ate the consecrated bread, which is lawful only for priests to eat. And he also gave some to his companions."
- 27 Then Jesus said, "The Sabbath was made to serve us; we weren't made to serve the Sabbath.
- 27 Then he said to them, "The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath.
- 28 The Son of Man is no lackey to the Sabbath. He's in charge!"
- 28 So the Son of Man is Lord even of the Sabbath."

Mark 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then he went back in the meeting place where he found a man with a crippled hand.
- 1 Another time he went into the synagogue, and a man with a shriveled hand was there.
- 2 The Pharisees had their eyes on Jesus to see if he would heal him, hoping to catch him in a Sabbath infraction.
- 2 Some of them were looking for a reason to accuse Jesus, so they watched him closely to see if he would heal him on the Sabbath.
- 3 He said to the man with the crippled hand, "Stand here where we can see you."

- 3 Jesus said to the man with the shriveled hand, "Stand up in front of everyone."
- 4 Then he spoke to the people: "What kind of action suits the Sabbath best? Doing good or doing evil? Helping people or leaving them helpless?" No one said a word.
- 4 Then Jesus asked them, "Which is lawful on the Sabbath: to do good or to do evil, to save life or to kill?" But they remained silent.
- 5 He looked them in the eye, one after another, angry now, furious at their hard-nosed religion. He said to the man, "Hold out your hand." He held it out--it was as good as new!
- 5 He looked around at them in anger and, deeply distressed at their stubborn hearts, said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." He stretched it out, and his hand was completely restored.
- 6 The Pharisees got out as fast as they could, sputtering about how they would join forces with Herod's followers and ruin him.
- 6 Then the Pharisees went out and began to plot with the Herodians how they might kill Jesus.
- 7 Jesus went off with his disciples to the sea to get away. But a huge crowd from Galilee trailed after them--
- 7 Jesus withdrew with his disciples to the lake, and a large crowd from Galilee followed.
- 8 also from Judea, Jerusalem, Idumea, across the Jordan, and around Tyre and Sidon--swarms of people who had heard the reports and had come to see for themselves.
- 8 When they heard all he was doing, many people came to him from Judea, Jerusalem, Idumea, and the regions across the Jordan and around Tyre and Sidon.
- 9 He told his disciples to get a boat ready so he wouldn't be trampled by the crowd.
- 9 Because of the crowd he told his disciples to have a small boat ready for him, to keep the people from crowding him.
- 10 He had healed many people, and now everyone who had something wrong was pushing and shoving to get near and touch him.
- 10 For he had healed many, so that those with diseases were pushing forward to touch him.

- 11 Evil spirits, when they recognized him, fell down and cried out, "You are the Son of God!"
- 11 Whenever the evil spirits saw him, they fell down before him and cried out, "You are the Son of God."
- 12 But Jesus would have none of it. He shut them up, forbidding them to identify him in public.
- 12 But he gave them strict orders not to tell who he was.
- 13 He climbed a mountain and invited those he wanted with him. They climbed together.
- 13 Jesus went up on a mountainside and called to him those he wanted, and they came to him.
- 14 He settled on twelve, and designated them apostles. The plan was that they would be with him, and he would send them out to proclaim the Word
- 14 He appointed twelve--designating them apostles--that they might be with him and that he might send them out to preach
- 15 and give them authority to banish demons.
- 15 and to have authority to drive out demons.
- 16 These are the Twelve: Simon (Jesus later named him Peter, meaning "Rock"),
- 16 These are the twelve he appointed: Simon (to whom he gave the name Peter);
- 17 James, son of Zebedee, John, brother of James (Jesus nicknamed the Zebedee brothers Boanerges, meaning "Sons of Thunder"),
- 17 James son of Zebedee and his brother John (to them he gave the name Boanerges, which means Sons of Thunder);
- 18 Andrew, Philip, Bartholomew, Matthew, Thomas, James, son of Alphaeus, Thaddaeus, Simon the Canaanite,
- 18 Andrew, Philip, Bartholomew, Matthew, Thomas, James son of Alphaeus, Thaddaeus, Simon the Zealot
- 19 Judas Iscariot (who betrayed him).
- 19 and Judas Iscariot, who betrayed him.
- 20 Jesus came home and, as usual, a crowd gathered--so many making demands on him that there wasn't even time to eat.
- 20 Then Jesus entered a house, and again a crowd gathered, so that he and his disciples were not even able to eat.

- 21 His friends heard what was going on and went to rescue him, by force if necessary. They suspected he was getting carried away with himself.
- 21 When his family heard about this, they went to take charge of him, for they said, "He is out of his mind."
- 22 The religion scholars from Jerusalem came down spreading rumors that he was working black magic, using devil tricks to impress them with spiritual power.
- 22 And the teachers of the law who came down from Jerusalem said, "He is possessed by Beelzebub! By the prince of demons he is driving out demons."
- 23 Jesus confronted their slander with a story: "Does it make sense to send a devil to catch a devil, to use Satan to get rid of Satan?"
- 23 So Jesus called them and spoke to them in parables: "How can Satan drive out Satan?"
- 24 A constantly squabbling family disintegrates. If Satan were fighting Satan, there soon wouldn't be any Satan left.
- 24 If a kingdom is divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand.
- 25 (SEE 3:24)
- 25 If a house is divided against itself, that house cannot stand.
- 26 (SEE 3:24)
- 26 And if Satan opposes himself and is divided, he cannot stand; his end has come.
- 27 Do you think it's possible in broad daylight to enter the house of an awake, able-bodied man, and walk off with his possessions unless you tie him up first? Tie him up, though, and you can clean him out.
- 27 In fact, no one can enter a strong man's house and carry off his possessions unless he first ties up the strong man. Then he can rob his house.
- 28 "Listen to this carefully. I'm warning you. There's nothing done or said that can't be forgiven.
- 28 I tell you the truth, all the sins and blasphemies of men will be forgiven them.
- 29 But if you persist in your slanders against God's Holy Spirit, you are repudiating the very One who forgives, sawing off the branch on which you're sitting, severing by your own perversity all connection with the One who forgives."

- 29 But whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit will never be forgiven; he is guilty of an eternal sin."
- 30 He gave this warning because they were accusing him of being in league with Evil.
- 30 He said this because they were saying, "He has an evil spirit."
- 31 Just then his mother and brothers showed up. Standing outside, they relayed a message that they wanted a word with him.
- 31 Then Jesus' mother and brothers arrived. Standing outside, they sent someone in to call him.
- 32 He was surrounded by the crowd when he was given the message, "Your mother and brothers and sisters are outside looking for you."
- 32 A crowd was sitting around him, and they told him, "Your mother and brothers are outside looking for you."
- 33 Jesus responded, "Who do you think are my mother and brothers?"
- 33 Who are my mother and my brothers? he asked.
- 34 Looking around, taking in everyone seated around him, he said, "Right here, right in front of you--my mother and my brothers.
- 34 Then he looked at those seated in a circle around him and said, "Here are my mother and my brothers!
- 35 Obedience is thicker than blood. The person who obeys God's will is my brother and sister and mother."
- 35 Whoever does God's will is my brother and sister and mother."

Mark 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 He went back to teaching by the sea. A crowd built up to such a great size that he had to get into an offshore boat, using the boat as a pulpit as the people pushed to the water's edge.
- 1 Again Jesus began to teach by the lake. The crowd that gathered around him was so large that he got into a boat and sat in it out on the lake, while all the people were along the shore at the water's edge.
- 2 He taught by using stories, many stories.
- 2 He taught them many things by parables, and in his teaching said:
- 3 "Listen. What do you make of this? A farmer planted seed.

3 Listen! A farmer went out to sow his seed.
4 As he scattered the seed, some of it fell on the road and birds ate it.
4 As he was scattering the seed, some fell along the path, and the birds came and ate it up.
5 Some fell in the gravel; it sprouted quickly but didn't put down roots,
5 Some fell on rocky places, where it did not have much soil. It sprang up quickly, because the soil was shallow.
6 so when the sun came up it withered just as quickly.
6 But when the sun came up, the plants were scorched, and they withered because they had no root.
7 Some fell in the weeds; as it came up, it was strangled among the weeds and nothing came of it.
7 Other seed fell among thorns, which grew up and choked the plants, so that they did not bear grain.
8 Some fell on good earth and came up with a flourish, producing a harvest exceeding his wildest dreams.
8 Still other seed fell on good soil. It came up, grew and produced a crop, multiplying thirty, sixty, or even a hundred times."
9 "Are you listening to this? Really listening?"
9 Then Jesus said, "He who has ears to hear, let him hear."
10 When they were off by themselves, those who were close to him, along with the Twelve, asked about the stories.
10 When he was alone, the Twelve and the others around him asked him about the parables.
11 He told them, "You've been given insight into God's kingdom--you know how it works. But to those who can't see it yet, everything comes in stories, creating readiness, nudging them toward receptive insight.
11 He told them, "The secret of the kingdom of God has been given to you. But to those on the outside everything is said in parables
12 These are people-- Whose eyes are open but don't see a thing, Whose ears are open but don't understand a word, Who avoid making an about-face and getting forgiven."
12 so that, " 'they may be ever seeing but never perceiving, and ever hearing but never understanding; otherwise they might turn and be forgiven!' "

- 13 He continued, "Do you see how this story works? All my stories work this way.
- 13 Then Jesus said to them, "Don't you understand this parable? How then will you understand any parable?
- 14 "The farmer plants the Word.
- 14 The farmer sows the word.
- 15 Some people are like the seed that falls on the hardened soil of the road. No sooner do they hear the Word than Satan snatches away what has been planted in them.
- 15 Some people are like seed along the path, where the word is sown. As soon as they hear it, Satan comes and takes away the word that was sown in them.
- 16 "And some are like the seed that lands in the gravel. When they first hear the Word, they respond with great enthusiasm.
- 16 Others, like seed sown on rocky places, hear the word and at once receive it with joy.
- 17 But there is such shallow soil of character that when the emotions wear off and some difficulty arrives, there is nothing to show for it.
- 17 But since they have no root, they last only a short time. When trouble or persecution comes because of the word, they quickly fall away.
- 18 "The seed cast in the weeds represents the ones who hear the kingdom news
- 18 Still others, like seed sown among thorns, hear the word;
- 19 but are overwhelmed with worries about all the things they have to do and all the things they want to get. The stress strangles what they heard, and nothing comes of it.
- 19 but the worries of this life, the deceitfulness of wealth and the desires for other things come in and choke the word, making it unfruitful.
- 20 "But the seed planted in the good earth represents those who hear the Word, embrace it, and produce a harvest beyond their wildest dreams."
- 20 Others, like seed sown on good soil, hear the word, accept it, and produce a crop-- thirty, sixty or even a hundred times what was sown."
- 21 Jesus went on: "Does anyone bring a lamp home and put it under a washtub or beneath the bed? Don't you put it up on a table or on the mantel?

- 21 He said to them, "Do you bring in a lamp to put it under a bowl or a bed? Instead, don't you put it on its stand?"
- 22 We're not keeping secrets, we're telling them; we're not hiding things, we're bringing them out into the open.
- 22 For whatever is hidden is meant to be disclosed, and whatever is concealed is meant to be brought out into the open.
- 23 "Are you listening to this? Really listening?"
- 23 If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear."
- 24 "Listen carefully to what I am saying--and be wary of the shrewd advice that tells you how to get ahead in the world on your own. Giving, not getting, is the way.
- 24 Consider carefully what you hear, he continued. "With the measure you use, it will be measured to you--and even more.
- 25 Generosity begets generosity. Stinginess impoverishes."
- 25 Whoever has will be given more; whoever does not have, even what he has will be taken from him."
- 26 Then Jesus said, "God's kingdom is like seed thrown on a field by a man
- 26 He also said, "This is what the kingdom of God is like. A man scatters seed on the ground.
- 27 who then goes to bed and forgets about it. The seed sprouts and grows--he has no idea how it happens.
- 27 Night and day, whether he sleeps or gets up, the seed sprouts and grows, though he does not know how.
- 28 The earth does it all without his help: first a green stem of grass, then a bud, then the ripened grain.
- 28 All by itself the soil produces grain--first the stalk, then the head, then the full kernel in the head.
- 29 When the grain is fully formed, he reaps--harvest time!
- 29 As soon as the grain is ripe, he puts the sickle to it, because the harvest has come."
- 30 "How can we picture God's kingdom? What kind of story can we use?"
- 30 Again he said, "What shall we say the kingdom of God is like, or what parable shall we use to describe it?"
- 31 It's like a pine nut. When it lands on the ground it is quite small as seeds go,

- 31 It is like a mustard seed, which is the smallest seed you plant in the ground.
- 32 yet once it is planted it grows into a huge pine tree with thick branches. Eagles nest in it."
- 32 Yet when planted, it grows and becomes the largest of all garden plants, with such big branches that the birds of the air can perch in its shade."
- 33 With many stories like these, he presented his message to them, fitting the stories to their experience and maturity.
- 33 With many similar parables Jesus spoke the word to them, as much as they could understand.
- 34 He was never without a story when he spoke. When he was alone with his disciples, he went over everything, sorting out the tangles, untying the knots.
- 34 He did not say anything to them without using a parable. But when he was alone with his own disciples, he explained everything.
- 35 Late that day he said to them, "Let's go across to the other side."
- 35 That day when evening came, he said to his disciples, "Let us go over to the other side."
- 36 They took him in the boat as he was. Other boats came along.
- 36 Leaving the crowd behind, they took him along, just as he was, in the boat. There were also other boats with him.
- 37 A huge storm came up. Waves poured into the boat, threatening to sink it.
- 37 A furious squall came up, and the waves broke over the boat, so that it was nearly swamped.
- 38 And Jesus was in the stern, head on a pillow, sleeping! They roused him, saying, "Teacher, is it nothing to you that we're going down?"
- 38 Jesus was in the stern, sleeping on a cushion. The disciples woke him and said to him, "Teacher, don't you care if we drown?"
- 39 Awake now, he told the wind to pipe down and said to the sea, "Quiet! Settle down!" The wind ran out of breath; the sea became smooth as glass.
- 39 He got up, rebuked the wind and said to the waves, "Quiet! Be still!" Then the wind died down and it was completely calm.
- 40 Jesus reprimanded the disciples: "Why are you such cowards? Don't you have any faith at all?"

- 40 He said to his disciples, "Why are you so afraid? Do you still have no faith?"
- 41 They were in absolute awe, staggered. "Who is this, anyway?" they asked. "Wind and sea at his beck and call!"
- 41 They were terrified and asked each other, "Who is this? Even the wind and the waves obey him!"

Mark 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 They arrived on the other side of the sea in the country of the Gerasenes.
- 1 They went across the lake to the region of the Gerasenes.
- 2 As Jesus got out of the boat, a madman from the cemetery came up to him.
- 2 When Jesus got out of the boat, a man with an evil spirit came from the tombs to meet him.
- 3 He lived there among the tombs and graves. No one could restrain him--he couldn't be chained, couldn't be tied down.
- 3 This man lived in the tombs, and no one could bind him any more, not even with a chain.
- 4 He had been tied up many times with chains and ropes, but he broke the chains, snapped the ropes. No one was strong enough to tame him.
- 4 For he had often been chained hand and foot, but he tore the chains apart and broke the irons on his feet. No one was strong enough to subdue him.
- 5 Night and day he roamed through the graves and the hills, screaming out and slashing himself with sharp stones.
- 5 Night and day among the tombs and in the hills he would cry out and cut himself with stones.
- 6 When he saw Jesus a long way off, he ran and bowed in worship before him--
- 6 When he saw Jesus from a distance, he ran and fell on his knees in front of him.
- 7 then bellowed in protest, "What business do you have, Jesus, Son of the High God, messing with me? I swear to God, don't give me a hard time!"

- 7 He shouted at the top of his voice, "What do you want with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? Swear to God that you won't torture me!"
- 8 (Jesus had just commanded the tormenting evil spirit, "Out! Get out of the man!")
- 8 For Jesus had said to him, "Come out of this man, you evil spirit!"
- 9 Jesus asked him, "Tell me your name." He replied, "My name is Mob. I'm a rioting mob."
- 9 Then Jesus asked him, "What is your name?" "My name is Legion," he replied, "for we are many."
- 10 Then he desperately begged Jesus not to banish them from the country.
- 10 And he begged Jesus again and again not to send them out of the area.
- 11 A large herd of pigs was browsing and rooting on a nearby hill.
- 11 A large herd of pigs was feeding on the nearby hillside.
- 12 The demons begged him, "Send us to the pigs so we can live in them."
- 12 The demons begged Jesus, "Send us among the pigs; allow us to go into them."
- 13 Jesus gave the order. But it was even worse for the pigs than for the man. Crazy, they stampeded over a cliff into the sea and drowned.
- 13 He gave them permission, and the evil spirits came out and went into the pigs. The herd, about two thousand in number, rushed down the steep bank into the lake and were drowned.
- 14 Those tending the pigs, scared to death, bolted and told their story in town and country. Everyone wanted to see what had happened.
- 14 Those tending the pigs ran off and reported this in the town and countryside, and the people went out to see what had happened.
- 15 They came up to Jesus and saw the madman sitting there wearing decent clothes and making sense, no longer a walking madhouse of a man.
- 15 When they came to Jesus, they saw the man who had been possessed by the legion of demons, sitting there, dressed and in his right mind; and they were afraid.
- 16 Those who had seen it told the others what had happened to the demon-possessed man and the pigs.
- 16 Those who had seen it told the people what had happened to the demon-possessed man--and told about the pigs as well.

17 At first they were in awe--and then they were upset, upset over the drowned pigs. They demanded that Jesus leave and not come back.

17 Then the people began to plead with Jesus to leave their region.

18 As Jesus was getting into the boat, the demon-delivered man begged to go along,

18 As Jesus was getting into the boat, the man who had been demon-possessed begged to go with him.

19 but he wouldn't let him. Jesus said, "Go home to your own people. Tell them your story--what the Master did, how he had mercy on you."

19 Jesus did not let him, but said, "Go home to your family and tell them how much the Lord has done for you, and how he has had mercy on you."

20 The man went back and began to preach in the Ten Towns area about what Jesus had done for him. He was the talk of the town.

20 So the man went away and began to tell in the Decapolis how much Jesus had done for him. And all the people were amazed.

21 After Jesus crossed over by boat, a large crowd met him at the seaside.

21 When Jesus had again crossed over by boat to the other side of the lake, a large crowd gathered around him while he was by the lake.

22 One of the meeting-place leaders named Jairus came. When he saw Jesus, he fell to his knees,

22 Then one of the synagogue rulers, named Jairus, came there. Seeing Jesus, he fell at his feet

23 beside himself as he begged, "My dear daughter is at death's door. Come and lay hands on her so she will get well and live."

23 and pleaded earnestly with him, "My little daughter is dying. Please come and put your hands on her so that she will be healed and live."

24 Jesus went with him, the whole crowd tagging along, pushing and jostling him.

24 So Jesus went with him. A large crowd followed and pressed around him.

25 A woman who had suffered a condition of hemorrhaging for twelve years--

25 And a woman was there who had been subject to bleeding for twelve years.

26 a long succession of physicians had treated her, and treated her badly, taking all her money and leaving her worse off than before--

26 She had suffered a great deal under the care of many doctors and had spent all she had, yet instead of getting better she grew worse.

27 had heard about Jesus. She slipped in from behind and touched his robe.

27 When she heard about Jesus, she came up behind him in the crowd and touched his cloak,

28 She was thinking to herself, "If I can put a finger on his robe, I can get well."

28 because she thought, "If I just touch his clothes, I will be healed."

29 The moment she did it, the flow of blood dried up. She could feel the change and knew her plague was over and done with.

29 Immediately her bleeding stopped and she felt in her body that she was freed from her suffering.

30 At the same moment, Jesus felt energy discharging from him. He turned around to the crowd and asked, "Who touched my robe?"

30 At once Jesus realized that power had gone out from him. He turned around in the crowd and asked, "Who touched my clothes?"

31 His disciples said, "What are you talking about? With this crowd pushing and jostling you, you're asking, 'Who touched me?' Dozens have touched you!"

31 You see the people crowding against you, his disciples answered, "and yet you can ask, 'Who touched me?' "

32 But he went on asking, looking around to see who had done it.

32 But Jesus kept looking around to see who had done it.

33 The woman, knowing what had happened, knowing she was the one, stepped up in fear and trembling, knelt before him, and gave him the whole story.

33 Then the woman, knowing what had happened to her, came and fell at his feet and, trembling with fear, told him the whole truth.

34 Jesus said to her, "Daughter, you took a risk of faith, and now you're healed and whole. Live well, live blessed! Be healed of your plague."

34 He said to her, "Daughter, your faith has healed you. Go in peace and be freed from your suffering."

35 While he was still talking, some people came from the leader's house and told him, "Your daughter is dead. Why bother the Teacher any

more?"

35 While Jesus was still speaking, some men came from the house of Jairus, the synagogue ruler. "Your daughter is dead," they said. "Why bother the teacher any more?"

36 Jesus overheard what they were talking about and said to the leader, "Don't listen to them; just trust me."

36 Ignoring what they said, Jesus told the synagogue ruler, "Don't be afraid; just believe."

37 He permitted no one to go in with him except Peter, James, and John.

37 He did not let anyone follow him except Peter, James and John the brother of James.

38 They entered the leader's house and pushed their way through the gossips looking for a story and neighbors bringing in casseroles.

38 When they came to the home of the synagogue ruler, Jesus saw a commotion, with people crying and wailing loudly.

39 Jesus was abrupt: "Why all this busybody grief and gossip? This child isn't dead; she's sleeping."

39 He went in and said to them, "Why all this commotion and wailing? The child is not dead but asleep."

40 Provoked to sarcasm, they told him he didn't know what he was talking about. But when he had sent them all out, he took the child's father and mother, along with his companions, and entered the child's room.

40 But they laughed at him. After he put them all out, he took the child's father and mother and the disciples who were with him, and went in where the child was.

41 He clasped the girl's hand and said, "Talitha koum," which means, "Little girl, get up."

41 He took her by the hand and said to her, "Talitha koum!" (which means, "Little girl, I say to you, get up!").

42 At that, she was up and walking around! This girl was twelve years of age. They, of course, were all beside themselves with joy.

42 Immediately the girl stood up and walked around (she was twelve years old). At this they were completely astonished.

43 He gave them strict orders that no one was to know what had taken place in that room. Then he said, "Give her something to eat."

43 He gave strict orders not to let anyone know about this, and told them to give her something to eat.

Mark 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 He left there and returned to his hometown. His disciples came along.
- 1 Jesus left there and went to his hometown, accompanied by his disciples.
- 2 On the Sabbath, he gave a lecture in the meeting place. He made a real hit, impressing everyone. "We had no idea he was this good!" they said. "How did he get so wise all of a sudden, get such ability?"
- 2 When the Sabbath came, he began to teach in the synagogue, and many who heard him were amazed. "Where did this man get these things?" they asked. "What's this wisdom that has been given him, that he even does miracles!"
- 3 But in the next breath they were cutting him down: "He's just a carpenter--Mary's boy. We've known him since he was a kid. We know his brothers, James, Justus, Jude, and Simon, and his sisters. Who does he think he is?" They tripped over what little they knew about him and fell, sprawling. And they never got any further.
- 3 Isn't this the carpenter? Isn't this Mary's son and the brother of James, Joseph, Judas and Simon? Aren't his sisters here with us?" And they took offense at him.
- 4 Jesus told them, "A prophet has little honor in his hometown, among his relatives, on the streets he played in as a child."
- 4 Jesus said to them, "Only in his hometown, among his relatives and in his own house is a prophet without honor."
- 5 Jesus wasn't able to do much of anything there--he laid hands on a few sick people and healed them, that's all.
- 5 He could not do any miracles there, except lay his hands on a few sick people and heal them.
- 6 He couldn't get over their stubbornness. He left and made a circuit of the other villages, teaching.
- 6 And he was amazed at their lack of faith. Then Jesus went around teaching from village to village.

- 7 Jesus called the Twelve to him, and sent them out in pairs. He gave them authority and power to deal with the evil opposition.
- 7 Calling the Twelve to him, he sent them out two by two and gave them authority over evil spirits.
- 8 He sent them off with these instructions: "Don't think you need a lot of extra equipment for this. You are the equipment. No special appeals for funds. Keep it simple.
- 8 These were his instructions: "Take nothing for the journey except a staff--no bread, no bag, no money in your belts.
- 9 (SEE 6:8)
- 9 Wear sandals but not an extra tunic.
- 10 "And no luxury inns. Get a modest place and be content there until you leave.
- 10 Whenever you enter a house, stay there until you leave that town.
- 11 "If you're not welcomed, not listened to, quietly withdraw. Don't make a scene. Shrug your shoulders and be on your way."
- 11 And if any place will not welcome you or listen to you, shake the dust off your feet when you leave, as a testimony against them."
- 12 Then they were on the road. They preached with joyful urgency that life can be radically different;
- 12 They went out and preached that people should repent.
- 13 right and left they sent the demons packing; they brought wellness to the sick, anointing their bodies, healing their spirits.
- 13 They drove out many demons and anointed many sick people with oil and healed them.
- 14 King Herod heard of all this, for by this time the name of Jesus was on everyone's lips. He said, "This has to be John the Baptizer come back from the dead--that's why he's able to work miracles!"
- 14 King Herod heard about this, for Jesus' name had become well known. Some were saying, "John the Baptist has been raised from the dead, and that is why miraculous powers are at work in him."
- 15 Others said, "No, it's Elijah." Others said, "He's a prophet, just like one of the old-time prophets."
- 15 Others said, "He is Elijah." And still others claimed, "He is a prophet, like one of the prophets of long ago."

- 16 But Herod wouldn't budge: "It's John, sure enough. I cut off his head, and now he's back, alive."
- 16 But when Herod heard this, he said, "John, the man I beheaded, has been raised from the dead!"
- 17 Herod was the one who had ordered the arrest of John, put him in chains, and sent him to prison at the nagging of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife.
- 17 For Herod himself had given orders to have John arrested, and he had him bound and put in prison. He did this because of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife, whom he had married.
- 18 For John had provoked Herod by naming his relationship with Herodias "adultery."
- 18 For John had been saying to Herod, "It is not lawful for you to have your brother's wife."
- 19 Herodias, smoldering with hate, wanted to kill him, but didn't dare
- 19 So Herodias nursed a grudge against John and wanted to kill him. But she was not able to,
- 20 because Herod was in awe of John. Convinced that he was a holy man, he gave him special treatment. Whenever he listened to him he was miserable with guilt--and yet he couldn't stay away. Something in John kept pulling him back.
- 20 because Herod feared John and protected him, knowing him to be a righteous and holy man. When Herod heard John, he was greatly puzzled; yet he liked to listen to him.
- 21 But a portentous day arrived when Herod threw a birthday party, inviting all the brass and bluebloods in Galilee.
- 21 Finally the opportune time came. On his birthday Herod gave a banquet for his high officials and military commanders and the leading men of Galilee.
- 22 Herodias's daughter entered the banquet hall and danced for the guests. She dazzled Herod and the guests. The king said to the girl, "Ask me anything. I'll give you anything you want."
- 22 When the daughter of Herodias came in and danced, she pleased Herod and his dinner guests. The king said to the girl, "Ask me for anything you want, and I'll give it to you."

23 Carried away, he kept on, "I swear, I'll split my kingdom with you if you say so!"

23 And he promised her with an oath, "Whatever you ask I will give you, up to half my kingdom."

24 She went back to her mother and said, "What should I ask for?" "Ask for the head of John the Baptizer."

24 She went out and said to her mother, "What shall I ask for?" "The head of John the Baptist," she answered.

25 Excited, she ran back to the king and said, "I want the head of John the Baptizer served up on a platter. And I want it now!"

25 At once the girl hurried in to the king with the request: "I want you to give me right now the head of John the Baptist on a platter."

26 That sobered the king up fast. But unwilling to lose face with his guests, he caved in and let her have her wish.

26 The king was greatly distressed, but because of his oaths and his dinner guests, he did not want to refuse her.

27 The king sent the executioner off to the prison with orders to bring back John's head. He went, cut off John's head,

27 So he immediately sent an executioner with orders to bring John's head. The man went, beheaded John in the prison,

28 brought it back on a platter, and presented it to the girl, who gave it to her mother.

28 and brought back his head on a platter. He presented it to the girl, and she gave it to her mother.

29 When John's disciples heard about this, they came and got the body and gave it a decent burial.

29 On hearing of this, John's disciples came and took his body and laid it in a tomb.

30 The apostles then rendezvoused with Jesus and reported on all that they had done and taught.

30 The apostles gathered around Jesus and reported to him all they had done and taught.

31 Jesus said, "Come off by yourselves; let's take a break and get a little rest." For there was constant coming and going. They didn't even have time to eat.

- 31 Then, because so many people were coming and going that they did not even have a chance to eat, he said to them, "Come with me by yourselves to a quiet place and get some rest."
- 32 So they got in the boat and went off to a remote place by themselves.
- 32 So they went away by themselves in a boat to a solitary place.
- 33 Someone saw them going and the word got around. From the surrounding towns people went out on foot, running, and got there ahead of them.
- 33 But many who saw them leaving recognized them and ran on foot from all the towns and got there ahead of them.
- 34 When Jesus arrived, he saw this huge crowd. At the sight of them, his heart broke--like sheep with no shepherd they were. He went right to work teaching them.
- 34 When Jesus landed and saw a large crowd, he had compassion on them, because they were like sheep without a shepherd. So he began teaching them many things.
- 35 When his disciples thought this had gone on long enough--it was now quite late in the day--they interrupted: "We are a long way out in the country, and it's very late.
- 35 By this time it was late in the day, so his disciples came to him. "This is a remote place," they said, "and it's already very late.
- 36 Pronounce a benediction and send these folks off so they can get some supper."
- 36 Send the people away so they can go to the surrounding countryside and villages and buy themselves something to eat."
- 37 Jesus said, "You do it. Fix supper for them." They replied, "Are you serious? You want us to go spend a fortune on food for their supper?"
- 37 But he answered, "You give them something to eat." They said to him, "That would take eight months of a man's wages! Are we to go and spend that much on bread and give it to them to eat?"
- 38 But he was quite serious. "How many loaves of bread do you have? Take an inventory." That didn't take long. "Five," they said, "plus two fish."
- 38 How many loaves do you have? he asked. "Go and see." When they found out, they said, "Five--and two fish."

39 Jesus got them all to sit down in groups of fifty or a hundred--they looked like a patchwork quilt of wildflowers spread out on the green grass!

39 Then Jesus directed them to have all the people sit down in groups on the green grass.

40 (SEE 6:39)

40 So they sat down in groups of hundreds and fifties.

41 He took the five loaves and two fish, lifted his face to heaven in prayer, blessed, broke, and gave the bread to the disciples, and the disciples in turn gave it to the people. He did the same with the fish.

41 Taking the five loaves and the two fish and looking up to heaven, he gave thanks and broke the loaves. Then he gave them to his disciples to set before the people. He also divided the two fish among them all.

42 They all ate their fill.

42 They all ate and were satisfied,

43 The disciples gathered twelve baskets of leftovers.

43 and the disciples picked up twelve basketfuls of broken pieces of bread and fish.

44 More than five thousand were at the supper.

44 The number of the men who had eaten was five thousand.

45 As soon as the meal was finished, Jesus insisted that the disciples get in the boat and go on ahead across to Bethsaida while he dismissed the congregation.

45 Immediately Jesus made his disciples get into the boat and go on ahead of him to Bethsaida, while he dismissed the crowd.

46 After sending them off, he climbed a mountain to pray.

46 After leaving them, he went up on a mountainside to pray.

47 Late at night, the boat was far out at sea; Jesus was still by himself on land.

47 When evening came, the boat was in the middle of the lake, and he was alone on land.

48 He could see his men struggling with the oars, the wind having come up against them. At about four o'clock in the morning, Jesus came toward them, walking on the sea. He intended to go right by them.

48 He saw the disciples straining at the oars, because the wind was against them. About the fourth watch of the night he went out to them, walking

on the lake. He was about to pass by them,
49 But when they saw him walking on the sea, they thought it was a ghost
and screamed, scared out of their wits.
49 but when they saw him walking on the lake, they thought he was a
ghost. They cried out,
50 Jesus was quick to comfort them: "Courage! It's me. Don't be afraid."
50 because they all saw him and were terrified. Immediately he spoke to
them and said, "Take courage! It is I. Don't be afraid."
51 As soon as he climbed into the boat, the wind died down. They were
stunned, shaking their heads, wondering what was going on.
51 Then he climbed into the boat with them, and the wind died down. They
were completely amazed,
52 They didn't understand what he had done at the supper. None of this had
yet penetrated their hearts.
52 for they had not understood about the loaves; their hearts were
hardened.
53 They beached the boat at Gennesaret and tied up at the landing.
53 When they had crossed over, they landed at Gennesaret and anchored
there.
54 As soon as they got out of the boat, word got around fast.
54 As soon as they got out of the boat, people recognized Jesus.
55 People ran this way and that, bringing their sick on stretchers to where
they heard he was.
55 They ran throughout that whole region and carried the sick on mats to
wherever they heard he was.
56 Wherever he went, village or town or country crossroads, they brought
their sick to the marketplace and begged him to let them touch the edge
of his coat--that's all. And whoever touched him became well.
56 And wherever he went--into villages, towns or countryside--they placed
the sick in the marketplaces. They begged him to let them touch even the
edge of his cloak, and all who touched him were healed.

Mark 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Pharisees, along with some religion scholars who had come from Jerusalem, gathered around him.
- 1 The Pharisees and some of the teachers of the law who had come from Jerusalem gathered around Jesus and
- 2 They noticed that some of his disciples weren't being careful with ritual washings before meals.
- 2 saw some of his disciples eating food with hands that were "unclean," that is, unwashed.
- 3 The Pharisees--Jews in general, in fact--would never eat a meal without going through the motions of a ritual hand-washing,
- 3 (The Pharisees and all the Jews do not eat unless they give their hands a ceremonial washing, holding to the tradition of the elders.
- 4 with an especially vigorous scrubbing if they had just come from the market (to say nothing of the scourings they'd give jugs and pots and pans).
- 4 When they come from the marketplace they do not eat unless they wash. And they observe many other traditions, such as the washing of cups, pitchers and kettles.)
- 5 The Pharisees and religion scholars asked, "Why do your disciples flout the rules, showing up at meals without washing their hands?"
- 5 So the Pharisees and teachers of the law asked Jesus, "Why don't your disciples live according to the tradition of the elders instead of eating their food with 'unclean' hands?"
- 6 Jesus answered, "Isaiah was right about frauds like you, hit the bull's-eye in fact: These people make a big show of saying the right thing, but their heart isn't in it.
- 6 He replied, "Isaiah was right when he prophesied about you hypocrites; as it is written: " "These people honor me with their lips, but their hearts are far from me.
- 7 They act like they are worshiping me, but they don't mean it. They just use me as a cover for teaching whatever suits their fancy,
- 7 They worship me in vain; their teachings are but rules taught by men.'
- 8 Ditching God's command and taking up the latest fads."
- 8 You have let go of the commands of God and are holding on to the traditions of men."

- 9 He went on, "Well, good for you. You get rid of God's command so you won't be inconvenienced in following the religious fashions!
- 9 And he said to them: "You have a fine way of setting aside the commands of God in order to observe your own traditions!
- 10 Moses said, 'Respect your father and mother,' and, 'Anyone denouncing father or mother should be killed.'
- 10 For Moses said, 'Honor your father and your mother,' and, 'Anyone who curses his father or mother must be put to death.'
- 11 But you weasel out of that by saying that it's perfectly acceptable to say to father or mother, 'Gift! What I owed you I've given as a gift to God,'
- 11 But you say that if a man says to his father or mother: 'Whatever help you might otherwise have received from me is Corban' (that is, a gift devoted to God),
- 12 thus relieving yourselves of obligation to father or mother.
- 12 then you no longer let him do anything for his father or mother.
- 13 You scratch out God's Word and scrawl a whim in its place. You do a lot of things like this."
- 13 Thus you nullify the word of God by your tradition that you have handed down. And you do many things like that."
- 14 Jesus called the crowd together again and said, "Listen now, all of you--take this to heart.
- 14 Again Jesus called the crowd to him and said, "Listen to me, everyone, and understand this.
- 15 It's not what you swallow that pollutes your life; it's what you vomit--that's the real pollution."
- 15 Nothing outside a man can make him 'unclean' by going into him. Rather, it is what comes out of a man that makes him 'unclean.' "
- 16 (OMITTED TEXT)
- 17 When he was back home after being with the crowd, his disciples said, "We don't get it. Put it in plain language."
- 17 After he had left the crowd and entered the house, his disciples asked him about this parable.
- 18 Jesus said, "Are you being willfully stupid? Don't you see that what you swallow can't contaminate you?

18 Are you so dull? he asked. "Don't you see that nothing that enters a man from the outside can make him 'unclean'?"

19 It doesn't enter your heart but your stomach, works its way through the intestines, and is finally flushed." (That took care of dietary quibbling; Jesus was saying that all foods are fit to eat.)

19 For it doesn't go into his heart but into his stomach, and then out of his body." (In saying this, Jesus declared all foods "clean.")

20 He went on: "It's what comes out of a person that pollutes:

20 He went on: "What comes out of a man is what makes him 'unclean.'

21 obscenities, lusts, thefts, murders, adulteries,

21 For from within, out of men's hearts, come evil thoughts, sexual immorality, theft, murder, adultery,

22 greed, depravity, deceptive dealings, carousing, mean looks, slander, arrogance, foolishness--

22 greed, malice, deceit, lewdness, envy, slander, arrogance and folly.

23 all these are vomit from the heart. There is the source of your pollution."

23 All these evils come from inside and make a man 'unclean.' "

24 From there Jesus set out for the vicinity of Tyre. He entered a house there where he didn't think he would be found, but he couldn't escape notice.

24 Jesus left that place and went to the vicinity of Tyre. He entered a house and did not want anyone to know it; yet he could not keep his presence secret.

25 He was barely inside when a woman who had a disturbed daughter heard where he was. She came and knelt at his feet,

25 In fact, as soon as she heard about him, a woman whose little daughter was possessed by an evil spirit came and fell at his feet.

26 begging for help. The woman was Greek, Syro-Phoenician by birth. She asked him to cure her daughter.

26 The woman was a Greek, born in Syrian Phoenicia. She begged Jesus to drive the demon out of her daughter.

27 He said, "Stand in line and take your turn. The children get fed first. If there's any left over, the dogs get it."

27 First let the children eat all they want, he told her, "for it is not right to take the children's bread and toss it to their dogs."

28 She said, "Of course, Master. But don't dogs under the table get scraps dropped by the children?"

28 Yes, Lord, she replied, "but even the dogs under the table eat the children's crumbs."

29 Jesus was impressed. "You're right! On your way! Your daughter is no longer disturbed. The demonic affliction is gone."

29 Then he told her, "For such a reply, you may go; the demon has left your daughter."

30 She went home and found her daughter relaxed on the bed, the torment gone for good.

30 She went home and found her child lying on the bed, and the demon gone.

31 Then he left the region of Tyre, went through Sidon back to Galilee Lake and over to the district of the Ten Towns.

31 Then Jesus left the vicinity of Tyre and went through Sidon, down to the Sea of Galilee and into the region of the Decapolis.

32 Some people brought a man who could neither hear nor speak and asked Jesus to lay a healing hand on him.

32 There some people brought to him a man who was deaf and could hardly talk, and they begged him to place his hand on the man.

33 He took the man off by himself, put his fingers in the man's ears and some spit on the man's tongue.

33 After he took him aside, away from the crowd, Jesus put his fingers into the man's ears. Then he spit and touched the man's tongue.

34 Then Jesus looked up in prayer, groaned mightily, and commanded, "Ephphatha!--Open up!"

34 He looked up to heaven and with a deep sigh said to him, "Ephphatha!" (which means, "Be opened!").

35 And it happened. The man's hearing was clear and his speech plain--just like that.

35 At this, the man's ears were opened, his tongue was loosened and he began to speak plainly.

36 Jesus urged them to keep it quiet, but they talked it up all the more,

36 Jesus commanded them not to tell anyone. But the more he did so, the more they kept talking about it.

- 37 beside themselves with excitement. "He's done it all and done it well. He gives hearing to the deaf, speech to the speechless."
- 37 People were overwhelmed with amazement. "He has done everything well," they said. "He even makes the deaf hear and the mute speak."

Mark 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 At about this same time he again found himself with a hungry crowd on his hands. He called his disciples together and said,
- 1 During those days another large crowd gathered. Since they had nothing to eat, Jesus called his disciples to him and said,
- 2 "This crowd is breaking my heart. They have stuck with me for three days, and now they have nothing to eat.
- 2 I have compassion for these people; they have already been with me three days and have nothing to eat.
- 3 If I send them home hungry, they'll faint along the way--some of them have come a long distance."
- 3 If I send them home hungry, they will collapse on the way, because some of them have come a long distance."
- 4 His disciples responded, "What do you expect us to do about it? Buy food out here in the desert?"
- 4 His disciples answered, "But where in this remote place can anyone get enough bread to feed them?"
- 5 He asked, "How much bread do you have?" "Seven loaves," they said.
- 5 How many loaves do you have? Jesus asked. "Seven," they replied.
- 6 So Jesus told the crowd to sit down on the ground. After giving thanks, he took the seven bread loaves, broke them into pieces, and gave them to his disciples so they could hand them out to the crowd.
- 6 He told the crowd to sit down on the ground. When he had taken the seven loaves and given thanks, he broke them and gave them to his disciples to set before the people, and they did so.
- 7 They also had a few fish. He pronounced a blessing over the fish and told his disciples to hand them out as well.

- 7 They had a few small fish as well; he gave thanks for them also and told the disciples to distribute them.
- 8 The crowd ate its fill. Seven sacks of leftovers were collected.
- 8 The people ate and were satisfied. Afterward the disciples picked up seven basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over.
- 9 There were well over four thousand at the meal. Then he sent them home.
- 9 About four thousand men were present. And having sent them away,
- 10 He himself went straight to the boat with his disciples and set out for Dalmanoutha.
- 10 he got into the boat with his disciples and went to the region of Dalmanutha.
- 11 When they arrived, the Pharisees came out and started in on him, badgering him to prove himself, pushing him up against the wall.
- 11 The Pharisees came and began to question Jesus. To test him, they asked him for a sign from heaven.
- 12 Provoked, he said, "Why does this generation clamor for miraculous guarantees? If I have anything to say about it, you'll not get so much as a hint of a guarantee."
- 12 He sighed deeply and said, "Why does this generation ask for a miraculous sign? I tell you the truth, no sign will be given to it."
- 13 He then left them, got back in the boat, and headed for the other side.
- 13 Then he left them, got back into the boat and crossed to the other side.
- 14 But the disciples forgot to pack a lunch. Except for a single loaf of bread, there wasn't a crumb in the boat.
- 14 The disciples had forgotten to bring bread, except for one loaf they had with them in the boat.
- 15 Jesus warned, "Be very careful. Keep a sharp eye out for the contaminating yeast of Pharisees and the followers of Herod."
- 15 Be careful, Jesus warned them. "Watch out for the yeast of the Pharisees and that of Herod."
- 16 Meanwhile, the disciples were finding fault with each other because they had forgotten to bring bread.
- 16 They discussed this with one another and said, "It is because we have no bread."
- 17 Jesus overheard and said, "Why are you fussing because you forgot bread? Don't you see the point of all this? Don't you get it at all?"

- 17 Aware of their discussion, Jesus asked them: "Why are you talking about having no bread? Do you still not see or understand? Are your hearts hardened?"
- 18 (SEE 8:17)
- 18 Do you have eyes but fail to see, and ears but fail to hear? And don't you remember?
- 19 Remember the five loaves I broke for the five thousand? How many baskets of leftovers did you pick up?" They said, "Twelve."
- 19 When I broke the five loaves for the five thousand, how many basketfuls of pieces did you pick up?" "Twelve," they replied.
- 20 "And the seven loaves for the four thousand--how many bags full of leftovers did you get?" "Seven."
- 20 And when I broke the seven loaves for the four thousand, how many basketfuls of pieces did you pick up? They answered, "Seven."
- 21 He said, "Do you still not get it?"
- 21 He said to them, "Do you still not understand?"
- 22 They arrived at Bethsaida. Some people brought a sightless man and begged Jesus to give him a healing touch.
- 22 They came to Bethsaida, and some people brought a blind man and begged Jesus to touch him.
- 23 Taking him by the hand, he led him out of the village. He put spit in the man's eyes, laid hands on him, and asked, "Do you see anything?"
- 23 He took the blind man by the hand and led him outside the village. When he had spit on the man's eyes and put his hands on him, Jesus asked, "Do you see anything?"
- 24 He looked up. "I see men. They look like walking trees."
- 24 He looked up and said, "I see people; they look like trees walking around."
- 25 So Jesus laid hands on his eyes again. The man looked hard and realized that he had recovered perfect sight, saw everything in bright, twenty-twenty focus.
- 25 Once more Jesus put his hands on the man's eyes. Then his eyes were opened, his sight was restored, and he saw everything clearly.
- 26 Jesus sent him straight home, telling him, "Don't enter the village."
- 26 Jesus sent him home, saying, "Don't go into the village. "

27 Jesus and his disciples headed out for the villages around Caesarea Philippi. As they walked, he asked, "Who do the people say I am?"

27 Jesus and his disciples went on to the villages around Caesarea Philippi. On the way he asked them, "Who do people say I am?"

28 "Some say 'John the Baptizer,'" they said. "Others say 'Elijah.' Still others say 'one of the prophets.'"

28 They replied, "Some say John the Baptist; others say Elijah; and still others, one of the prophets."

29 He then asked, "And you--what are you saying about me? Who am I?" Peter gave the answer: "You are the Christ, the Messiah."

29 But what about you? he asked. "Who do you say I am?" Peter answered, "You are the Christ. "

30 Jesus warned them to keep it quiet, not to breathe a word of it to anyone.

30 Jesus warned them not to tell anyone about him.

31 He then began explaining things to them: "It is necessary that the Son of Man proceed to an ordeal of suffering, be tried and found guilty by the elders, high priests, and religion scholars, be killed, and after three days rise up alive."

31 He then began to teach them that the Son of Man must suffer many things and be rejected by the elders, chief priests and teachers of the law, and that he must be killed and after three days rise again.

32 He said this simply and clearly so they couldn't miss it. But Peter grabbed him in protest.

32 He spoke plainly about this, and Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him.

33 Turning and seeing his disciples wavering, wondering what to believe, Jesus confronted Peter. "Peter, get out of my way! Satan, get lost! You have no idea how God works."

33 But when Jesus turned and looked at his disciples, he rebuked Peter. "Get behind me, Satan!" he said. "You do not have in mind the things of God, but the things of men."

34 Calling the crowd to join his disciples, he said, "Anyone who intends to come with me has to let me lead. You're not in the driver's seat; I am. Don't run from suffering; embrace it. Follow me and I'll show you how.

- 34 Then he called the crowd to him along with his disciples and said: "If anyone would come after me, he must deny himself and take up his cross and follow me.
- 35 Self-help is no help at all. Self-sacrifice is the way, my way, to saving yourself, your true self.
- 35 For whoever wants to save his life will lose it, but whoever loses his life for me and for the gospel will save it.
- 36 What good would it do to get everything you want and lose you, the real you?
- 36 What good is it for a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?
- 37 What could you ever trade your soul for?
- 37 Or what can a man give in exchange for his soul?
- 38 "If any of you are embarrassed over me and the way I'm leading you when you get around your fickle and unfocused friends, know that you'll be an even greater embarrassment to the Son of Man when he arrives in all the splendor of God, his Father, with an army of the holy angels."
- 38 If anyone is ashamed of me and my words in this adulterous and sinful generation, the Son of Man will be ashamed of him when he comes in his Father's glory with the holy angels."

Mark 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then he drove it home by saying, "This isn't pie in the sky by and by. Some of you who are standing here are going to see it happen, see the kingdom of God arrive in full force."
- 1 And he said to them, "I tell you the truth, some who are standing here will not taste death before they see the kingdom of God come with power."
- 2 Six days later, three of them did see it. Jesus took Peter, James, and John and led them up a high mountain. His appearance changed from the inside out, right before their eyes.
- 2 After six days Jesus took Peter, James and John with him and led them up a high mountain, where they were all alone. There he was transfigured before them.

- 3 His clothes shimmered, glistening white, whiter than any bleach could make them.
- 3 His clothes became dazzling white, whiter than anyone in the world could bleach them.
- 4 Elijah, along with Moses, came into view, in deep conversation with Jesus.
- 4 And there appeared before them Elijah and Moses, who were talking with Jesus.
- 5 Peter interrupted, "Rabbi, this is a great moment! Let's build three memorials--one for you, one for Moses, one for Elijah."
- 5 Peter said to Jesus, "Rabbi, it is good for us to be here. Let us put up three shelters--one for you, one for Moses and one for Elijah."
- 6 He blurted this out without thinking, stunned as they all were by what they were seeing.
- 6 (He did not know what to say, they were so frightened.)
- 7 Just then a light-radiant cloud enveloped them, and from deep in the cloud, a voice: "This is my Son, marked by my love. Listen to him."
- 7 Then a cloud appeared and enveloped them, and a voice came from the cloud: "This is my Son, whom I love. Listen to him!"
- 8 The next minute the disciples were looking around, rubbing their eyes, seeing nothing but Jesus, only Jesus.
- 8 Suddenly, when they looked around, they no longer saw anyone with them except Jesus.
- 9 Coming down the mountain, Jesus swore them to secrecy. "Don't tell a soul what you saw. After the Son of Man rises from the dead, you're free to talk."
- 9 As they were coming down the mountain, Jesus gave them orders not to tell anyone what they had seen until the Son of Man had risen from the dead.
- 10 They puzzled over that, wondering what on earth "rising from the dead" meant.
- 10 They kept the matter to themselves, discussing what "rising from the dead" meant.
- 11 Meanwhile they were asking, "Why do the religion scholars say that Elijah has to come first?"

- 11 And they asked him, "Why do the teachers of the law say that Elijah must come first?"
- 12 Jesus replied, "Elijah does come first and get everything ready for the coming of the Son of Man. They treated this Elijah like dirt, much like they will treat the Son of Man, who will, according to Scripture, suffer terribly and be kicked around contemptibly."
- 12 Jesus replied, "To be sure, Elijah does come first, and restores all things. Why then is it written that the Son of Man must suffer much and be rejected?"
- 13 (SEE 9:12)
- 13 But I tell you, Elijah has come, and they have done to him everything they wished, just as it is written about him."
- 14 When they came back down the mountain to the other disciples, they saw a huge crowd around them, and the religion scholars cross-examining them.
- 14 When they came to the other disciples, they saw a large crowd around them and the teachers of the law arguing with them.
- 15 As soon as the people in the crowd saw Jesus, admiring excitement stirred them. They ran and greeted him.
- 15 As soon as all the people saw Jesus, they were overwhelmed with wonder and ran to greet him.
- 16 He asked, "What's going on? What's all the commotion?"
- 16 What are you arguing with them about? he asked.
- 17 A man out of the crowd answered, "Teacher, I brought my mute son, made speechless by a demon, to you.
- 17 A man in the crowd answered, "Teacher, I brought you my son, who is possessed by a spirit that has robbed him of speech.
- 18 Whenever it seizes him, it throws him to the ground. He foams at the mouth, grinds his teeth, and goes stiff as a board. I told your disciples, hoping they could deliver him, but they couldn't."
- 18 Whenever it seizes him, it throws him to the ground. He foams at the mouth, gnashes his teeth and becomes rigid. I asked your disciples to drive out the spirit, but they could not."
- 19 Jesus said, "What a generation! No sense of God! How many times do I have to go over these things? How much longer do I have to put up with this? Bring the boy here."

19 O unbelieving generation, Jesus replied, "how long shall I stay with you? How long shall I put up with you? Bring the boy to me."

20 They brought him. When the demon saw Jesus, it threw the boy into a seizure, causing him to writhe on the ground and foam at the mouth.

20 So they brought him. When the spirit saw Jesus, it immediately threw the boy into a convulsion. He fell to the ground and rolled around, foaming at the mouth.

21 He asked the boy's father, "How long has this been going on?" "Ever since he was a little boy."

21 Jesus asked the boy's father, "How long has he been like this?" "From childhood," he answered.

22 Many times it pitches him into fire or the river to do away with him. If you can do anything, do it. Have a heart and help us!"

22 It has often thrown him into fire or water to kill him. But if you can do anything, take pity on us and help us.

23 Jesus said, "If? There are no 'ifs' among believers. Anything can happen."

23 'If you can'? said Jesus. "Everything is possible for him who believes."

24 No sooner were the words out of his mouth than the father cried, "Then I believe. Help me with my doubts!"

24 Immediately the boy's father exclaimed, "I do believe; help me overcome my unbelief!"

25 Seeing that the crowd was forming fast, Jesus gave the vile spirit its marching orders: "Dumb and deaf spirit, I command you--Out of him, and stay out!"

25 When Jesus saw that a crowd was running to the scene, he rebuked the evil spirit. "You deaf and mute spirit," he said, "I command you, come out of him and never enter him again."

26 Screaming, and with much thrashing about, it left. The boy was pale as a corpse, so people started saying, "He's dead."

26 The spirit shrieked, convulsed him violently and came out. The boy looked so much like a corpse that many said, "He's dead."

27 But Jesus, taking his hand, raised him. The boy stood up.

27 But Jesus took him by the hand and lifted him to his feet, and he stood up.

28 After arriving back home, his disciples cornered Jesus and asked, "Why couldn't we throw the demon out?"

28 After Jesus had gone indoors, his disciples asked him privately, "Why couldn't we drive it out?"

29 He answered, "There is no way to get rid of this kind of demon except by prayer."

29 He replied, "This kind can come out only by prayer. "

30 Leaving there, they went through Galilee. He didn't want anyone to know their whereabouts,

30 They left that place and passed through Galilee. Jesus did not want anyone to know where they were,

31 for he wanted to teach his disciples. He told them, "The Son of Man is about to be betrayed to some people who want nothing to do with God. They will murder him. Three days after his murder, he will rise, alive."

31 because he was teaching his disciples. He said to them, "The Son of Man is going to be betrayed into the hands of men. They will kill him, and after three days he will rise."

32 They didn't know what he was talking about, but were afraid to ask him about it.

32 But they did not understand what he meant and were afraid to ask him about it.

33 They came to Capernaum. When he was safe at home, he asked them, "What were you discussing on the road?"

33 They came to Capernaum. When he was in the house, he asked them, "What were you arguing about on the road?"

34 The silence was deafening--they had been arguing with one another over who among them was greatest.

34 But they kept quiet because on the way they had argued about who was the greatest.

35 He sat down and summoned the Twelve. "So you want first place? Then take the last place. Be the servant of all."

35 Sitting down, Jesus called the Twelve and said, "If anyone wants to be first, he must be the very last, and the servant of all."

36 He put a child in the middle of the room. Then, cradling the little one in his arms, he said,

36 He took a little child and had him stand among them. Taking him in his arms, he said to them,

37 "Whoever embraces one of these children as I do embraces me, and far more than me--God who sent me."

37 Whoever welcomes one of these little children in my name welcomes me; and whoever welcomes me does not welcome me but the one who sent me.

38 John spoke up, "Teacher, we saw a man using your name to expel demons and we stopped him because he wasn't in our group."

38 Teacher, said John, "we saw a man driving out demons in your name and we told him to stop, because he was not one of us."

39 Jesus wasn't pleased. "Don't stop him. No one can use my name to do something good and powerful, and in the next breath cut me down.

39 Do not stop him, Jesus said. "No one who does a miracle in my name can in the next moment say anything bad about me,

40 If he's not an enemy, he's an ally.

40 for whoever is not against us is for us.

41 Why, anyone by just giving you a cup of water in my name is on our side. Count on it that God will notice.

41 I tell you the truth, anyone who gives you a cup of water in my name because you belong to Christ will certainly not lose his reward.

42 "On the other hand, if you give one of these simple, childlike believers a hard time, bullying or taking advantage of their simple trust, you'll soon wish you hadn't. You'd be better off dropped in the middle of the lake with a millstone around your neck.

42 And if anyone causes one of these little ones who believe in me to sin, it would be better for him to be thrown into the sea with a large millstone tied around his neck.

43 "If your hand or your foot gets in God's way, chop it off and throw it away. You're better off maimed or lame and alive than the proud owner of two hands and two feet, godless in a furnace of eternal fire.

43 If your hand causes you to sin, cut it off. It is better for you to enter life maimed than with two hands to go into hell, where the fire never goes out.

44 (SEE 9:43)

45 (SEE 9:43)

45 And if your foot causes you to sin, cut it off. It is better for you to enter life crippled than to have two feet and be thrown into hell.

46 (SEE 9:43)

47 And if your eye distracts you from God, pull it out and throw it away.

47 And if your eye causes you to sin, pluck it out. It is better for you to enter the kingdom of God with one eye than to have two eyes and be thrown into hell,

48 You're better off one-eyed and alive than exercising your twenty-twenty vision from inside the fire of hell.

48 where " 'their worm does not die, and the fire is not quenched.' "

49 "Everyone's going through a refining fire sooner or later,

49 Everyone will be salted with fire.

50 but you'll be well-preserved, protected from the eternal flames. Be preservatives yourselves. Preserve the peace."

50 Salt is good, but if it loses its saltiness, how can you make it salty again? Have salt in yourselves, and be at peace with each other.

Mark 10

MSG

NIV

1 From there he went to the area of Judea across the Jordan. A crowd of people, as was so often the case, went along, and he, as he so often did, taught them.

1 Jesus then left that place and went into the region of Judea and across the Jordan. Again crowds of people came to him, and as was his custom, he taught them.

2 Pharisees came up, intending to give him a hard time. They asked, "Is it legal for a man to divorce his wife?"

2 Some Pharisees came and tested him by asking, "Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife?"

3 Jesus said, "What did Moses command?"

3 What did Moses command you? he replied.

- 4 They answered, "Moses gave permission to fill out a certificate of dismissal and divorce her."
- 4 They said, "Moses permitted a man to write a certificate of divorce and send her away."
- 5 Jesus said, "Moses wrote this command only as a concession to your hardhearted ways.
- 5 It was because your hearts were hard that Moses wrote you this law, Jesus replied.
- 6 In the original creation, God made male and female to be together.
- 6 But at the beginning of creation God 'made them male and female.'
- 7 Because of this, a man leaves father and mother, and in marriage
- 7 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife,
- 8 he becomes one flesh with a woman--no longer two individuals, but forming a new unity.
- 8 and the two will become one flesh.' So they are no longer two, but one.
- 9 Because God created this organic union of the two sexes, no one should desecrate his art by cutting them apart."
- 9 Therefore what God has joined together, let man not separate."
- 10 When they were back home, the disciples brought it up again.
- 10 When they were in the house again, the disciples asked Jesus about this.
- 11 Jesus gave it to them straight: "A man who divorces his wife so he can marry someone else commits adultery against her.
- 11 He answered, "Anyone who divorces his wife and marries another woman commits adultery against her.
- 12 And a woman who divorces her husband so she can marry someone else commits adultery."
- 12 And if she divorces her husband and marries another man, she commits adultery."
- 13 The people brought children to Jesus, hoping he might touch them.
- 13 People were bringing little children to Jesus to have him touch them, but the disciples rebuked them.
- 14 The disciples shooed them off. But Jesus was irate and let them know it: "Don't push these children away. Don't ever get between them and me. These children are at the very center of life in the kingdom.

- 14 When Jesus saw this, he was indignant. He said to them, "Let the little children come to me, and do not hinder them, for the kingdom of God belongs to such as these.
- 15 Mark this: Unless you accept God's kingdom in the simplicity of a child, you'll never get in."
- 15 I tell you the truth, anyone who will not receive the kingdom of God like a little child will never enter it."
- 16 Then, gathering the children up in his arms, he laid his hands of blessing on them.
- 16 And he took the children in his arms, put his hands on them and blessed them.
- 17 As he went out into the street, a man came running up, greeted him with great reverence, and asked, "Good Teacher, what must I do to get eternal life?"
- 17 As Jesus started on his way, a man ran up to him and fell on his knees before him. "Good teacher," he asked, "what must I do to inherit eternal life?"
- 18 Jesus said, "Why are you calling me good? No one is good, only God.
- 18 Why do you call me good? Jesus answered. "No one is good--except God alone.
- 19 You know the commandments: Don't murder, don't commit adultery, don't steal, don't lie, don't cheat, honor your father and mother."
- 19 You know the commandments: 'Do not murder, do not commit adultery, do not steal, do not give false testimony, do not defraud, honor your father and mother.' "
- 20 He said, "Teacher, I have--from my youth--kept them all!"
- 20 Teacher, he declared, "all these I have kept since I was a boy."
- 21 Jesus looked him hard in the eye--and loved him! He said, "There's one thing left: Go sell whatever you own and give it to the poor. All your wealth will then be heavenly wealth. And come follow me."
- 21 Jesus looked at him and loved him. "One thing you lack," he said. "Go, sell everything you have and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven. Then come, follow me."
- 22 The man's face clouded over. This was the last thing he expected to hear, and he walked off with a heavy heart. He was holding on tight to a lot of things, and not about to let go.

- 22 At this the man's face fell. He went away sad, because he had great wealth.
- 23 Looking at his disciples, Jesus said, "Do you have any idea how difficult it is for people who 'have it all' to enter God's kingdom?"
- 23 Jesus looked around and said to his disciples, "How hard it is for the rich to enter the kingdom of God!"
- 24 The disciples couldn't believe what they were hearing, but Jesus kept on: "You can't imagine how difficult.
- 24 The disciples were amazed at his words. But Jesus said again, "Children, how hard it is to enter the kingdom of God!
- 25 I'd say it's easier for a camel to go through a needle's eye than for the rich to get into God's kingdom."
- 25 It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God."
- 26 That set the disciples back on their heels. "Then who has any chance at all?" they asked.
- 26 The disciples were even more amazed, and said to each other, "Who then can be saved?"
- 27 Jesus was blunt: "No chance at all if you think you can pull it off by yourself. Every chance in the world if you let God do it."
- 27 Jesus looked at them and said, "With man this is impossible, but not with God; all things are possible with God."
- 28 Peter tried another angle: "We left everything and followed you."
- 28 Peter said to him, "We have left everything to follow you!"
- 29 Jesus said, "Mark my words, no one who sacrifices house, brothers, sisters, mother, father, children, land--whatever--because of me and the Message
- 29 I tell you the truth, Jesus replied, "no one who has left home or brothers or sisters or mother or father or children or fields for me and the gospel
- 30 will lose out. They'll get it all back, but multiplied many times in homes, brothers, sisters, mothers, children, and land--but also in troubles. And then the bonus of eternal life!
- 30 will fail to receive a hundred times as much in this present age (homes, brothers, sisters, mothers, children and fields--and with them, persecutions) and in the age to come, eternal life.

- 31 This is once again the Great Reversal: Many who are first will end up last, and the last first."
- 31 But many who are first will be last, and the last first."
- 32 Back on the road, they set out for Jerusalem. Jesus had a head start on them, and they were following, puzzled and not just a little afraid. He took the Twelve and began again to go over what to expect next.
- 32 They were on their way up to Jerusalem, with Jesus leading the way, and the disciples were astonished, while those who followed were afraid. Again he took the Twelve aside and told them what was going to happen to him.
- 33 "Listen to me carefully. We're on our way up to Jerusalem. When we get there, the Son of Man will be betrayed to the religious leaders and scholars. They will sentence him to death. Then they will hand him over to the Romans,
- 33 We are going up to Jerusalem, he said, "and the Son of Man will be betrayed to the chief priests and teachers of the law. They will condemn him to death and will hand him over to the Gentiles,
- 34 who will mock and spit on him, give him the third degree, and kill him. After three days he will rise alive."
- 34 who will mock him and spit on him, flog him and kill him. Three days later he will rise."
- 35 James and John, Zebedee's sons, came up to him. "Teacher, we have something we want you to do for us."
- 35 Then James and John, the sons of Zebedee, came to him. "Teacher," they said, "we want you to do for us whatever we ask."
- 36 "What is it? I'll see what I can do."
- 36 What do you want me to do for you? he asked.
- 37 "Arrange it," they said, "so that we will be awarded the highest places of honor in your glory--one of us at your right, the other at your left."
- 37 They replied, "Let one of us sit at your right and the other at your left in your glory."
- 38 Jesus said, "You have no idea what you're asking. Are you capable of drinking the cup I drink, of being baptized in the baptism I'm about to be plunged into?"
- 38 You don't know what you are asking, Jesus said. "Can you drink the cup I drink or be baptized with the baptism I am baptized with?"

39 "Sure," they said. "Why not?" Jesus said, "Come to think of it, you will drink the cup I drink, and be baptized in my baptism.

39 We can, they answered. Jesus said to them, "You will drink the cup I drink and be baptized with the baptism I am baptized with,

40 But as to awarding places of honor, that's not my business. There are other arrangements for that."

40 but to sit at my right or left is not for me to grant. These places belong to those for whom they have been prepared."

41 When the other ten heard of this conversation, they lost their tempers with James and John.

41 When the ten heard about this, they became indignant with James and John.

42 Jesus got them together to settle things down. "You've observed how godless rulers throw their weight around," he said, "and when people get a little power how quickly it goes to their heads.

42 Jesus called them together and said, "You know that those who are regarded as rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and their high officials exercise authority over them.

43 It's not going to be that way with you. Whoever wants to be great must become a servant.

43 Not so with you. Instead, whoever wants to become great among you must be your servant,

44 Whoever wants to be first among you must be your slave.

44 and whoever wants to be first must be slave of all.

45 That is what the Son of Man has done: He came to serve, not to be served--and then to give away his life in exchange for many who are held hostage."

45 For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many."

46 They spent some time in Jericho. As Jesus was leaving town, trailed by his disciples and a parade of people, a blind beggar by the name of Bartimaeus, son of Timaeus, was sitting alongside the road.

46 Then they came to Jericho. As Jesus and his disciples, together with a large crowd, were leaving the city, a blind man, Bartimaeus (that is, the Son of Timaeus), was sitting by the roadside begging.

- 47 When he heard that Jesus the Nazarene was passing by, he began to cry out, "Son of David, Jesus! Mercy, have mercy on me!"
- 47 When he heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, he began to shout, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!"
- 48 Many tried to hush him up, but he yelled all the louder, "Son of David! Mercy, have mercy on me!"
- 48 Many rebuked him and told him to be quiet, but he shouted all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!"
- 49 Jesus stopped in his tracks. "Call him over." They called him. "It's your lucky day! Get up! He's calling you to come!"
- 49 Jesus stopped and said, "Call him." So they called to the blind man, "Cheer up! On your feet! He's calling you."
- 50 Throwing off his coat, he was on his feet at once and came to Jesus.
- 50 Throwing his cloak aside, he jumped to his feet and came to Jesus.
- 51 Jesus said, "What can I do for you?" The blind man said, "Rabbi, I want to see."
- 51 What do you want me to do for you? Jesus asked him. The blind man said, "Rabbi, I want to see."
- 52 "On your way," said Jesus. "Your faith has saved and healed you." In that very instant he recovered his sight and followed Jesus down the road.
- 52 Go, said Jesus, "your faith has healed you." Immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus along the road.

Mark 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 When they were nearing Jerusalem, at Bethphage and Bethany on Mount Olives, he sent off two of the disciples with instructions:
- 1 As they approached Jerusalem and came to Bethphage and Bethany at the Mount of Olives, Jesus sent two of his disciples,
- 2 "Go to the village across from you. As soon as you enter, you'll find a colt tethered, one that has never yet been ridden. Untie it and bring it.
- 2 saying to them, "Go to the village ahead of you, and just as you enter it, you will find a colt tied there, which no one has ever ridden. Untie it and

- bring it here.
- 3 If anyone asks, 'What are you doing?' say, 'The Master needs him, and will return him right away.'"
- 3 If anyone asks you, 'Why are you doing this?' tell him, 'The Lord needs it and will send it back here shortly.' "
- 4 They went and found a colt tied to a door at the street corner and untied it.
- 4 They went and found a colt outside in the street, tied at a doorway. As they untied it,
- 5 Some of those standing there said, "What are you doing untying that colt?"
- 5 some people standing there asked, "What are you doing, untying that colt?"
- 6 The disciples replied exactly as Jesus had instructed them, and the people let them alone.
- 6 They answered as Jesus had told them to, and the people let them go.
- 7 They brought the colt to Jesus, spread their coats on it, and he mounted.
- 7 When they brought the colt to Jesus and threw their cloaks over it, he sat on it.
- 8 The people gave him a wonderful welcome, some throwing their coats on the street, others spreading out rushes they had cut in the fields.
- 8 Many people spread their cloaks on the road, while others spread branches they had cut in the fields.
- 9 Running ahead and following after, they were calling out, Hosanna! Blessed is he who comes in God's name!
- 9 Those who went ahead and those who followed shouted, "Hosanna! " "Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!"
- 10 Blessed the coming kingdom of our father David! Hosanna in highest heaven!
- 10 Blessed is the coming kingdom of our father David! "Hosanna in the highest!"
- 11 He entered Jerusalem, then entered the Temple. He looked around, taking it all in. But by now it was late, so he went back to Bethany with the Twelve.
- 11 Jesus entered Jerusalem and went to the temple. He looked around at everything, but since it was already late, he went out to Bethany with the

Twelve.

- 12 As they left Bethany the next day, he was hungry.
- 12 The next day as they were leaving Bethany, Jesus was hungry.
- 13 Off in the distance he saw a fig tree in full leaf. He came up to it expecting to find something for breakfast, but found nothing but fig leaves. (It wasn't yet the season for figs.)
- 13 Seeing in the distance a fig tree in leaf, he went to find out if it had any fruit. When he reached it, he found nothing but leaves, because it was not the season for figs.
- 14 He addressed the tree: "No one is going to eat fruit from you again--ever!" And his disciples overheard him.
- 14 Then he said to the tree, "May no one ever eat fruit from you again." And his disciples heard him say it.
- 15 They arrived at Jerusalem. Immediately on entering the Temple Jesus started throwing out everyone who had set up shop there, buying and selling. He kicked over the tables of the bankers and the stalls of the pigeon merchants.
- 15 On reaching Jerusalem, Jesus entered the temple area and began driving out those who were buying and selling there. He overturned the tables of the money changers and the benches of those selling doves,
- 16 He didn't let anyone even carry a basket through the Temple.
- 16 and would not allow anyone to carry merchandise through the temple courts.
- 17 And then he taught them, quoting this text: My house was designated a house of prayer for the nations; You've turned it into a hangout for thieves.
- 17 And as he taught them, he said, "Is it not written: " 'My house will be called a house of prayer for all nations' ? But you have made it 'a den of robbers.' "
- 18 The high priests and religion scholars heard what was going on and plotted how they might get rid of him. They panicked, for the entire crowd was carried away by his teaching.
- 18 The chief priests and the teachers of the law heard this and began looking for a way to kill him, for they feared him, because the whole crowd was amazed at his teaching.
- 19 At evening, Jesus and his disciples left the city.

- 19 When evening came, they went out of the city.
- 20 In the morning, walking along the road, they saw the fig tree, shriveled to a dry stick.
- 20 In the morning, as they went along, they saw the fig tree withered from the roots.
- 21 Peter, remembering what had happened the previous day, said to him, "Rabbi, look--the fig tree you cursed is shriveled up!"
- 21 Peter remembered and said to Jesus, "Rabbi, look! The fig tree you cursed has withered!"
- 22 Jesus was matter-of-fact: "Embrace this God-life. Really embrace it,
- 22 Have faith in God, Jesus answered.
- 23 and nothing will be too much for you. This mountain, for instance: Just say, 'Go jump in the lake'--no shuffling or shilly-shallying--and it's as good as done.
- 23 I tell you the truth, if anyone says to this mountain, 'Go, throw yourself into the sea,' and does not doubt in his heart but believes that what he says will happen, it will be done for him.
- 24 That's why I urge you to pray for absolutely everything, ranging from small to large. Include everything as you embrace this God-life, and you'll get God's everything.
- 24 Therefore I tell you, whatever you ask for in prayer, believe that you have received it, and it will be yours.
- 25 And when you assume the posture of prayer, remember that it's not all asking. If you have anything against someone, forgive--only then will your heavenly Father be inclined to also wipe your slate clean of sins."
- 25 And when you stand praying, if you hold anything against anyone, forgive him, so that your Father in heaven may forgive you your sins. "
- 26 (OMITTED TEXT)
- 27 Then when they were back in Jerusalem once again, as they were walking through the Temple, the high priests, religion scholars, and leaders came up
- 27 They arrived again in Jerusalem, and while Jesus was walking in the temple courts, the chief priests, the teachers of the law and the elders came to him.

- 28 and demanded, "Show us your credentials. Who authorized you to speak and act like this?"
- 28 By what authority are you doing these things? they asked. "And who gave you authority to do this?"
- 29 Jesus responded, "First let me ask you a question. Answer my question and then I'll present my credentials.
- 29 Jesus replied, "I will ask you one question. Answer me, and I will tell you by what authority I am doing these things.
- 30 About the baptism of John--who authorized it: heaven or humans? Tell me."
- 30 John's baptism--was it from heaven, or from men? Tell me!"
- 31 They were on the spot, and knew it. They pulled back into a huddle and whispered, "If we say 'heaven,' he'll ask us why we didn't believe John;
- 31 They discussed it among themselves and said, "If we say, 'From heaven,' he will ask, 'Then why didn't you believe him?'
- 32 if we say 'humans,' we'll be up against it with the people because they all hold John up as a prophet."
- 32 But if we say, 'From men'" (They feared the people, for everyone held that John really was a prophet.)
- 33 They decided to concede that round to Jesus. "We don't know," they said. Jesus replied, "Then I won't answer your question either."
- 33 So they answered Jesus, "We don't know." Jesus said, "Neither will I tell you by what authority I am doing these things."

Mark 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then Jesus started telling them stories. "A man planted a vineyard. He fenced it, dug a winepress, erected a watchtower, turned it over to the farmhands, and went off on a trip.
- 1 He then began to speak to them in parables: "A man planted a vineyard. He put a wall around it, dug a pit for the winepress and built a watchtower. Then he rented the vineyard to some farmers and went away on a journey.

- 2 At the time for harvest, he sent a servant back to the farmhands to collect his profits.
- 2 At harvest time he sent a servant to the tenants to collect from them some of the fruit of the vineyard.
- 3 "They grabbed him, beat him up, and sent him off empty-handed.
- 3 But they seized him, beat him and sent him away empty-handed.
- 4 So he sent another servant. That one they tarred and feathered.
- 4 Then he sent another servant to them; they struck this man on the head and treated him shamefully.
- 5 He sent another and that one they killed. And on and on, many others. Some they beat up, some they killed.
- 5 He sent still another, and that one they killed. He sent many others; some of them they beat, others they killed.
- 6 "Finally there was only one left: a beloved son. In a last-ditch effort, he sent him, thinking, 'Surely they will respect my son.'
- 6 He had one left to send, a son, whom he loved. He sent him last of all, saying, 'They will respect my son.'
- 7 "But those farmhands saw their chance. They rubbed their hands together in greed and said, 'This is the heir! Let's kill him and have it all for ourselves.'
- 7 But the tenants said to one another, 'This is the heir. Come, let's kill him, and the inheritance will be ours.'
- 8 They grabbed him, killed him, and threw him over the fence.
- 8 So they took him and killed him, and threw him out of the vineyard.
- 9 "What do you think the owner of the vineyard will do? Right. He'll come and clean house. Then he'll assign the care of the vineyard to others.
- 9 What then will the owner of the vineyard do? He will come and kill those tenants and give the vineyard to others.
- 10 Read it for yourselves in Scripture: That stone the masons threw out is now the cornerstone!
- 10 Haven't you read this scripture: " 'The stone the builders rejected has become the capstone;
- 11 This is God's work; we rub our eyes--we can hardly believe it!"
- 11 the Lord has done this, and it is marvelous in our eyes' ?"
- 12 They wanted to lynch him then and there but, intimidated by public opinion, held back. They knew the story was about them. They got away

from there as fast as they could.

12 Then they looked for a way to arrest him because they knew he had spoken the parable against them. But they were afraid of the crowd; so they left him and went away.

13 They sent some Pharisees and followers of Herod to bait him, hoping to catch him saying something incriminating.

13 Later they sent some of the Pharisees and Herodians to Jesus to catch him in his words.

14 They came up and said, "Teacher, we know you have integrity, that you are indifferent to public opinion, don't pander to your students, and teach the way of God accurately. Tell us: Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar or not?"

14 They came to him and said, "Teacher, we know you are a man of integrity. You aren't swayed by men, because you pay no attention to who they are; but you teach the way of God in accordance with the truth. Is it right to pay taxes to Caesar or not?"

15 He knew it was a trick question, and said, "Why are you playing these games with me? Bring me a coin and let me look at it."

15 Should we pay or shouldn't we?" But Jesus knew their hypocrisy. "Why are you trying to trap me?" he asked. "Bring me a denarius and let me look at it."

16 They handed him one. "This engraving--who does it look like? And whose name is on it?" "Caesar," they said.

16 They brought the coin, and he asked them, "Whose portrait is this? And whose inscription?" "Caesar's," they replied.

17 Jesus said, "Give Caesar what is his, and give God what is his." Their mouths hung open, speechless.

17 Then Jesus said to them, "Give to Caesar what is Caesar's and to God what is God's." And they were amazed at him.

18 Some Sadducees, the party that denies any possibility of resurrection, came up and asked,

18 Then the Sadducees, who say there is no resurrection, came to him with a question.

19 "Teacher, Moses wrote that if a man dies and leaves a wife but no child, his brother is obligated to marry the widow and have children.

- 19 Teacher, they said, "Moses wrote for us that if a man's brother dies and leaves a wife but no children, the man must marry the widow and have children for his brother.
- 20 Well, there once were seven brothers. The first took a wife. He died childless.
- 20 Now there were seven brothers. The first one married and died without leaving any children.
- 21 The second married her. He died, and still no child. The same with the third.
- 21 The second one married the widow, but he also died, leaving no child. It was the same with the third.
- 22 All seven took their turn, but no child. Finally the wife died.
- 22 In fact, none of the seven left any children. Last of all, the woman died too.
- 23 When they are raised at the resurrection, whose wife is she? All seven were her husband."
- 23 At the resurrection whose wife will she be, since the seven were married to her?"
- 24 Jesus said, "You're way off base, and here's why: One, you don't know your Bibles; two, you don't know how God works.
- 24 Jesus replied, "Are you not in error because you do not know the Scriptures or the power of God?
- 25 After the dead are raised up, we're past the marriage business. As it is with angels now, all our ecstasies and intimacies then will be with God.
- 25 When the dead rise, they will neither marry nor be given in marriage; they will be like the angels in heaven.
- 26 And regarding the dead, whether or not they are raised, don't you ever read the Bible? How God at the bush said to Moses, 'I am--not was--the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob'?
- 26 Now about the dead rising--have you not read in the book of Moses, in the account of the bush, how God said to him, 'I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob' ?
- 27 The living God is God of the living, not the dead. You're way, way off base."
- 27 He is not the God of the dead, but of the living. You are badly mistaken!"

- 28 One of the religion scholars came up. Hearing the lively exchanges of question and answer and seeing how sharp Jesus was in his answers, he put in his question: "Which is most important of all the commandments?"
- 28 One of the teachers of the law came and heard them debating. Noticing that Jesus had given them a good answer, he asked him, "Of all the commandments, which is the most important?"
- 29 Jesus said, "The first in importance is, 'Listen, Israel: The Lord your God is one;
- 29 The most important one, answered Jesus, "is this: 'Hear, O Israel, the Lord our God, the Lord is one.
- 30 so love the Lord God with all your passion and prayer and intelligence and energy.'
- 30 Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength.'
- 31 And here is the second: 'Love others as well as you love yourself.' There is no other commandment that ranks with these."
- 31 The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' There is no commandment greater than these."
- 32 The religion scholar said, "A wonderful answer, Teacher! So lucid and accurate--that God is one and there is no other.
- 32 Well said, teacher, the man replied. "You are right in saying that God is one and there is no other but him.
- 33 And loving him with all passion and intelligence and energy, and loving others as well as you love yourself. Why, that's better than all offerings and sacrifices put together!"
- 33 To love him with all your heart, with all your understanding and with all your strength, and to love your neighbor as yourself is more important than all burnt offerings and sacrifices."
- 34 When Jesus realized how insightful he was, he said, "You're almost there, right on the border of God's kingdom." After that, no one else dared ask a question.
- 34 When Jesus saw that he had answered wisely, he said to him, "You are not far from the kingdom of God." And from then on no one dared ask him any more questions.

35 While he was teaching in the Temple, Jesus asked, "How is it that the religion scholars say that the Messiah is David's 'son,'

35 While Jesus was teaching in the temple courts, he asked, "How is it that the teachers of the law say that the Christ is the son of David?

36 when we all know that David, inspired by the Holy Spirit, said, God said to my Master, "Sit here at my right hand until I put your enemies under your feet."

36 David himself, speaking by the Holy Spirit, declared: " 'The Lord said to my Lord: "Sit at my right hand until I put your enemies under your feet." ' "

37 "David here designates the Messiah 'my Master'--so how can the Messiah also be his 'son'?" The large crowd was delighted with what they heard.

37 David himself calls him 'Lord.' How then can he be his son?" The large crowd listened to him with delight.

38 He continued teaching. "Watch out for the religion scholars. They love to walk around in academic gowns, preening in the radiance of public flattery,

38 As he taught, Jesus said, "Watch out for the teachers of the law. They like to walk around in flowing robes and be greeted in the marketplaces,

39 basking in prominent positions, sitting at the head table at every church function.

39 and have the most important seats in the synagogues and the places of honor at banquets.

40 And all the time they are exploiting the weak and helpless. The longer their prayers, the worse they get. But they'll pay for it in the end."

40 They devour widows' houses and for a show make lengthy prayers. Such men will be punished most severely."

41 Sitting across from the offering box, he was observing how the crowd tossed money in for the collection. Many of the rich were making large contributions.

41 Jesus sat down opposite the place where the offerings were put and watched the crowd putting their money into the temple treasury. Many rich people threw in large amounts.

42 One poor widow came up and put in two small coins--a measly two cents.

- 42 But a poor widow came and put in two very small copper coins, worth only a fraction of a penny.
- 43 Jesus called his disciples over and said, "The truth is that this poor widow gave more to the collection than all the others put together.
- 43 Calling his disciples to him, Jesus said, "I tell you the truth, this poor widow has put more into the treasury than all the others.
- 44 All the others gave what they'll never miss; she gave extravagantly what she couldn't afford--she gave her all."
- 44 They all gave out of their wealth; but she, out of her poverty, put in everything--all she had to live on."

Mark 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 As he walked away from the Temple, one of his disciples said, "Teacher, look at that stonework! Those buildings!"
- 1 As he was leaving the temple, one of his disciples said to him, "Look, Teacher! What massive stones! What magnificent buildings!"
- 2 Jesus said, "You're impressed by this grandiose architecture? There's not a stone in the whole works that is not going to end up in a heap of rubble."
- 2 Do you see all these great buildings? replied Jesus. "Not one stone here will be left on another; every one will be thrown down."
- 3 Later, as he was sitting on Mount Olives in full view of the Temple, Peter, James, John, and Andrew got him off by himself and asked,
- 3 As Jesus was sitting on the Mount of Olives opposite the temple, Peter, James, John and Andrew asked him privately,
- 4 "Tell us, when is this going to happen? What sign will we get that things are coming to a head?"
- 4 Tell us, when will these things happen? And what will be the sign that they are all about to be fulfilled?
- 5 Jesus began, "Watch out for doomsday deceivers.
- 5 Jesus said to them: "Watch out that no one deceives you.
- 6 Many leaders are going to show up with forged identities claiming, 'I'm the One.' They will deceive a lot of people.

- 6 Many will come in my name, claiming, 'I am he,' and will deceive many.
- 7 When you hear of wars and rumored wars, keep your head and don't panic. This is routine history, and no sign of the end.
- 7 When you hear of wars and rumors of wars, do not be alarmed. Such things must happen, but the end is still to come.
- 8 Nation will fight nation and ruler fight ruler, over and over. Earthquakes will occur in various places. There will be famines. But these things are nothing compared to what's coming.
- 8 Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. There will be earthquakes in various places, and famines. These are the beginning of birth pains.
- 9 "And watch out! They're going to drag you into court. And then it will go from bad to worse, dog-eat-dog, everyone at your throat because you carry my name. You're placed there as sentinels to truth.
- 9 You must be on your guard. You will be handed over to the local councils and flogged in the synagogues. On account of me you will stand before governors and kings as witnesses to them.
- 10 The Message has to be preached all across the world.
- 10 And the gospel must first be preached to all nations.
- 11 "When they bring you, betrayed, into court, don't worry about what you'll say. When the time comes, say what's on your heart--the Holy Spirit will make his witness in and through you.
- 11 Whenever you are arrested and brought to trial, do not worry beforehand about what to say. Just say whatever is given you at the time, for it is not you speaking, but the Holy Spirit.
- 12 "It's going to be brother killing brother, father killing child, children killing parents.
- 12 Brother will betray brother to death, and a father his child. Children will rebel against their parents and have them put to death.
- 13 There's no telling who will hate you because of me. "Stay with it--that's what is required. Stay with it to the end. You won't be sorry; you'll be saved.
- 13 All men will hate you because of me, but he who stands firm to the end will be saved.
- 14 "But be ready to run for it when you see the monster of desecration set up where it should never be. You who can read, make sure you

- understand what I'm talking about. If you're living in Judea at the time, run for the hills;
- 14 When you see 'the abomination that causes desolation' standing where it does not belong--let the reader understand--then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains.
- 15 if you're working in the yard, don't go back to the house to get anything;
- 15 Let no one on the roof of his house go down or enter the house to take anything out.
- 16 if you're out in the field, don't go back to get your coat.
- 16 Let no one in the field go back to get his cloak.
- 17 Pregnant and nursing mothers will have it especially hard.
- 17 How dreadful it will be in those days for pregnant women and nursing mothers!
- 18 Hope and pray this won't happen in the middle of winter.
- 18 Pray that this will not take place in winter,
- 19 "These are going to be hard days--nothing like it from the time God made the world right up to the present. And there'll be nothing like it again.
- 19 because those will be days of distress unequalled from the beginning, when God created the world, until now--and never to be equaled again.
- 20 If he let the days of trouble run their course, nobody would make it. But because of God's chosen people, those he personally chose, he has already intervened.
- 20 If the Lord had not cut short those days, no one would survive. But for the sake of the elect, whom he has chosen, he has shortened them.
- 21 "If anyone tries to flag you down, calling out, 'Here's the Messiah!' or points, 'There he is!' don't fall for it.
- 21 At that time if anyone says to you, 'Look, here is the Christ!' or, 'Look, there he is!' do not believe it.
- 22 Fake Messiahs and lying preachers are going to pop up everywhere. Their impressive credentials and dazzling performances will pull the wool over the eyes of even those who ought to know better.
- 22 For false Christs and false prophets will appear and perform signs and miracles to deceive the elect--if that were possible.
- 23 So watch out. I've given you fair warning.
- 23 So be on your guard; I have told you everything ahead of time.

24 "Following those hard times, Sun will fade out, moon cloud over,
24 But in those days, following that distress, 'the sun will be darkened, and
the moon will not give its light;
25 Stars fall out of the sky, cosmic powers tremble.
25 the stars will fall from the sky, and the heavenly bodies will be shaken.'
26 "And then they'll see the Son of Man enter in grand style, his Arrival
filling the sky--no one will miss it!
26 At that time men will see the Son of Man coming in clouds with great
power and glory.
27 He'll dispatch the angels; they will pull in the chosen from the four
winds, from pole to pole.
27 And he will send his angels and gather his elect from the four winds,
from the ends of the earth to the ends of the heavens.
28 "Take a lesson from the fig tree. From the moment you notice its buds
form, the merest hint of green, you know summer's just around the
corner.
28 Now learn this lesson from the fig tree: As soon as its twigs get tender
and its leaves come out, you know that summer is near.
29 And so it is with you. When you see all these things, you know he is at
the door.
29 Even so, when you see these things happening, you know that it is near,
right at the door.
30 Don't take this lightly. I'm not just saying this for some future
generation, but for this one, too--these things will happen.
30 I tell you the truth, this generation will certainly not pass away until all
these things have happened.
31 Sky and earth will wear out; my words won't wear out.
31 Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will never pass away.
32 "But the exact day and hour? No one knows that, not even heaven's
angels, not even the Son. Only the Father.
32 No one knows about that day or hour, not even the angels in heaven, nor
the Son, but only the Father.
33 So keep a sharp lookout, for you don't know the timetable.
33 Be on guard! Be alert! You do not know when that time will come.
34 It's like a man who takes a trip, leaving home and putting his servants in
charge, each assigned a task, and commanding the gatekeeper to stand

watch.

34 It's like a man going away: He leaves his house and puts his servants in charge, each with his assigned task, and tells the one at the door to keep watch.

35 So, stay at your post, watching. You have no idea when the homeowner is returning, whether evening, midnight, cockcrow, or morning.

35 Therefore keep watch because you do not know when the owner of the house will come back--whether in the evening, or at midnight, or when the rooster crows, or at dawn.

36 You don't want him showing up unannounced, with you asleep on the job.

36 If he comes suddenly, do not let him find you sleeping.

37 I say it to you, and I'm saying it to all: Stay at your post. Keep watch."

37 What I say to you, I say to everyone: 'Watch!' "

Mark 14

MSG

NIV

1 In only two days the eight-day Festival of Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread would begin. The high priests and religion scholars were looking for a way they could seize Jesus by stealth and kill him.

1 Now the Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread were only two days away, and the chief priests and the teachers of the law were looking for some sly way to arrest Jesus and kill him.

2 They agreed that it should not be done during Passover Week. "We don't want the crowds up in arms," they said.

2 But not during the Feast, they said, "or the people may riot."

3 Jesus was at Bethany, a guest of Simon the Leper. While he was eating dinner, a woman came up carrying a bottle of very expensive perfume. Opening the bottle, she poured it on his head.

3 While he was in Bethany, reclining at the table in the home of a man known as Simon the Leper, a woman came with an alabaster jar of very expensive perfume, made of pure nard. She broke the jar and poured the perfume on his head.

- 4 Some of the guests became furious among themselves. "That's criminal! A sheer waste!
- 4 Some of those present were saying indignantly to one another, "Why this waste of perfume?
- 5 This perfume could have been sold for well over a year's wages and handed out to the poor." They swelled up in anger, nearly bursting with indignation over her.
- 5 It could have been sold for more than a year's wages and the money given to the poor." And they rebuked her harshly.
- 6 But Jesus said, "Let her alone. Why are you giving her a hard time? She has just done something wonderfully significant for me.
- 6 Leave her alone, said Jesus. "Why are you bothering her? She has done a beautiful thing to me.
- 7 You will have the poor with you every day for the rest of your lives. Whenever you feel like it, you can do something for them. Not so with me.
- 7 The poor you will always have with you, and you can help them any time you want. But you will not always have me.
- 8 She did what she could when she could--she pre-anointed my body for burial.
- 8 She did what she could. She poured perfume on my body beforehand to prepare for my burial.
- 9 And you can be sure that wherever in the whole world the Message is preached, what she just did is going to be talked about admiringly."
- 9 I tell you the truth, wherever the gospel is preached throughout the world, what she has done will also be told, in memory of her."
- 10 Judas Iscariot, one of the Twelve, went to the cabal of high priests, determined to betray him.
- 10 Then Judas Iscariot, one of the Twelve, went to the chief priests to betray Jesus to them.
- 11 They couldn't believe their ears, and promised to pay him well. He started looking for just the right moment to hand him over.
- 11 They were delighted to hear this and promised to give him money. So he watched for an opportunity to hand him over.
- 12 On the first of the Days of Unleavened Bread, the day they prepare the Passover sacrifice, his disciples asked him, "Where do you want us to go

- and make preparations so you can eat the Passover meal?"
- 12 On the first day of the Feast of Unleavened Bread, when it was customary to sacrifice the Passover lamb, Jesus' disciples asked him, "Where do you want us to go and make preparations for you to eat the Passover?"
- 13 He directed two of his disciples, "Go into the city. A man carrying a water jug will meet you. Follow him.
- 13 So he sent two of his disciples, telling them, "Go into the city, and a man carrying a jar of water will meet you. Follow him.
- 14 Ask the owner of whichever house he enters, 'The Teacher wants to know, Where is my guest room where I can eat the Passover meal with my disciples?'
- 14 Say to the owner of the house he enters, 'The Teacher asks: Where is my guest room, where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?'
- 15 He will show you a spacious second-story room, swept and ready. Prepare for us there."
- 15 He will show you a large upper room, furnished and ready. Make preparations for us there."
- 16 The disciples left, came to the city, found everything just as he had told them, and prepared the Passover meal.
- 16 The disciples left, went into the city and found things just as Jesus had told them. So they prepared the Passover.
- 17 After sunset he came with the Twelve.
- 17 When evening came, Jesus arrived with the Twelve.
- 18 As they were at the supper table eating, Jesus said, "I have something hard but important to say to you: One of you is going to hand me over to the conspirators, one who at this moment is eating with me."
- 18 While they were reclining at the table eating, he said, "I tell you the truth, one of you will betray me--one who is eating with me."
- 19 Stunned, they started asking, one after another, "It isn't me, is it?"
- 19 They were saddened, and one by one they said to him, "Surely not I?"
- 20 He said, "It's one of the Twelve, one who eats with me out of the same bowl.
- 20 It is one of the Twelve, he replied, "one who dips bread into the bowl with me.

- 21 In one sense, it turns out that the Son of Man is entering into a way of treachery well-marked by the Scriptures--no surprises here. In another sense, the man who turns him in, turns traitor to the Son of Man--better never to have been born than do this!"
- 21 The Son of Man will go just as it is written about him. But woe to that man who betrays the Son of Man! It would be better for him if he had not been born."
- 22 In the course of their meal, having taken and blessed the bread, he broke it and gave it to them. Then he said, Take, this is my body.
- 22 While they were eating, Jesus took bread, gave thanks and broke it, and gave it to his disciples, saying, "Take it; this is my body."
- 23 Taking the chalice, he gave it to them, thanking God, and they all drank from it.
- 23 Then he took the cup, gave thanks and offered it to them, and they all drank from it.
- 24 He said, This is my blood, God's new covenant, Poured out for many people.
- 24 This is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many, he said to them.
- 25 "I'll not be drinking wine again until the new day when I drink it in the kingdom of God."
- 25 I tell you the truth, I will not drink again of the fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it anew in the kingdom of God.
- 26 They sang a hymn and then went directly to Mount Olives.
- 26 When they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.
- 27 Jesus told them, "You're all going to feel that your world is falling apart and that it's my fault. There's a Scripture that says, I will strike the shepherd; The sheep will go helter-skelter.
- 27 You will all fall away, Jesus told them, "for it is written: " 'I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered.'
- 28 "But after I am raised up, I will go ahead of you, leading the way to Galilee."
- 28 But after I have risen, I will go ahead of you into Galilee."
- 29 Peter blurted out, "Even if everyone else is ashamed of you when things fall to pieces, I won't be."
- 29 Peter declared, "Even if all fall away, I will not."

30 Jesus said, "Don't be so sure. Today, this very night in fact, before the rooster crows twice, you will deny me three times."

30 I tell you the truth, Jesus answered, "today--yes, tonight--before the rooster crows twice you yourself will disown me three times."

31 He blustered in protest, "Even if I have to die with you, I will never deny you." All the others said the same thing.

31 But Peter insisted emphatically, "Even if I have to die with you, I will never disown you." And all the others said the same.

32 They came to an area called Gethsemane. Jesus told his disciples, "Sit here while I pray."

32 They went to a place called Gethsemane, and Jesus said to his disciples, "Sit here while I pray."

33 He took Peter, James, and John with him. He plunged into a sinkhole of dreadful agony.

33 He took Peter, James and John along with him, and he began to be deeply distressed and troubled.

34 He told them, "I feel bad enough right now to die. Stay here and keep vigil with me."

34 My soul is overwhelmed with sorrow to the point of death, he said to them. "Stay here and keep watch."

35 Going a little ahead, he fell to the ground and prayed for a way out:

35 Going a little farther, he fell to the ground and prayed that if possible the hour might pass from him.

36 "Papa, Father, you can--can't you?--get me out of this. Take this cup away from me. But please, not what I want--what do you want?"

36 Abba, Father, he said, "everything is possible for you. Take this cup from me. Yet not what I will, but what you will."

37 He came back and found them sound asleep. He said to Peter, "Simon, you went to sleep on me? Can't you stick it out with me a single hour?"

37 Then he returned to his disciples and found them sleeping. "Simon," he said to Peter, "are you asleep? Could you not keep watch for one hour?"

38 Stay alert, be in prayer, so you don't enter the danger zone without even knowing it. Don't be naive. Part of you is eager, ready for anything in God; but another part is as lazy as an old dog sleeping by the fire."

38 Watch and pray so that you will not fall into temptation. The spirit is willing, but the body is weak."

39 He then went back and prayed the same prayer.
39 Once more he went away and prayed the same thing.
40 Returning, he again found them sound asleep. They simply couldn't keep their eyes open, and they didn't have a plausible excuse.
40 When he came back, he again found them sleeping, because their eyes were heavy. They did not know what to say to him.
41 He came back a third time and said, "Are you going to sleep all night? No--you've slept long enough. Time's up. The Son of Man is about to be betrayed into the hands of sinners.
41 Returning the third time, he said to them, "Are you still sleeping and resting? Enough! The hour has come. Look, the Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.
42 Get up. Let's get going. My betrayer has arrived."
42 Rise! Let us go! Here comes my betrayer!"
43 No sooner were the words out of his mouth when Judas, the one out of the Twelve, showed up, and with him a gang of ruffians, sent by the high priests, religion scholars, and leaders, brandishing swords and clubs.
43 Just as he was speaking, Judas, one of the Twelve, appeared. With him was a crowd armed with swords and clubs, sent from the chief priests, the teachers of the law, and the elders.
44 The betrayer had worked out a signal with them: "The one I kiss, that's the one--seize him. Make sure he doesn't get away."
44 Now the betrayer had arranged a signal with them: "The one I kiss is the man; arrest him and lead him away under guard."
45 He went straight to Jesus and said, "Rabbi!" and kissed him.
45 Going at once to Jesus, Judas said, "Rabbi!" and kissed him.
46 The others then grabbed him and roughed him up.
46 The men seized Jesus and arrested him.
47 One of the men standing there unsheathed his sword, swung, and came down on the Chief Priest's servant, lopping off the man's ear.
47 Then one of those standing near drew his sword and struck the servant of the high priest, cutting off his ear.
48 Jesus said to them, "What is this, coming after me with swords and clubs as if I were a dangerous criminal?
48 Am I leading a rebellion, said Jesus, "that you have come out with swords and clubs to capture me?

49 Day after day I've been sitting in the Temple teaching, and you never so much as lifted a hand against me. What you in fact have done is confirm the prophetic writings."

49 Every day I was with you, teaching in the temple courts, and you did not arrest me. But the Scriptures must be fulfilled."

50 All the disciples cut and ran.

50 Then everyone deserted him and fled.

51 A young man was following along. All he had on was a bedsheet. Some of the men grabbed him

51 A young man, wearing nothing but a linen garment, was following Jesus. When they seized him,

52 but he got away, running off naked, leaving them holding the sheet.

52 he fled naked, leaving his garment behind.

53 They led Jesus to the Chief Priest, where the high priests, religious leaders, and scholars had gathered together.

53 They took Jesus to the high priest, and all the chief priests, elders and teachers of the law came together.

54 Peter followed at a safe distance until they got to the Chief Priest's courtyard, where he mingled with the servants and warmed himself at the fire.

54 Peter followed him at a distance, right into the courtyard of the high priest. There he sat with the guards and warmed himself at the fire.

55 The high priests conspiring with the Jewish Council looked high and low for evidence against Jesus by which they could sentence him to death. They found nothing.

55 The chief priests and the whole Sanhedrin were looking for evidence against Jesus so that they could put him to death, but they did not find any.

56 Plenty of people were willing to bring in false charges, but nothing added up, and they ended up canceling each other out.

56 Many testified falsely against him, but their statements did not agree.

57 Then a few of them stood up and lied:

57 Then some stood up and gave this false testimony against him:

58 "We heard him say, 'I am going to tear down this Temple, built by hard labor, and in three days build another without lifting a hand.'"

58 We heard him say, 'I will destroy this man-made temple and in three days will build another, not made by man.'

59 But even they couldn't agree exactly.

59 Yet even then their testimony did not agree.

60 In the middle of this, the Chief Priest stood up and asked Jesus, "What do you have to say to the accusation?"

60 Then the high priest stood up before them and asked Jesus, "Are you not going to answer? What is this testimony that these men are bringing against you?"

61 Jesus was silent. He said nothing. The Chief Priest tried again, this time asking, "Are you the Messiah, the Son of the Blessed?"

61 But Jesus remained silent and gave no answer. Again the high priest asked him, "Are you the Christ, the Son of the Blessed One?"

62 Jesus said, "Yes, I am, and you'll see it yourself: The Son of Man seated At the right hand of the Mighty One, Arriving on the clouds of heaven."

62 I am, said Jesus. "And you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of the Mighty One and coming on the clouds of heaven."

63 The Chief Priest lost his temper. Ripping his clothes, he yelled, "Did you hear that? After that do we need witnesses?"

63 The high priest tore his clothes. "Why do we need any more witnesses?" he asked.

64 You heard the blasphemy. Are you going to stand for it?" They condemned him, one and all. The sentence: death.

64 You have heard the blasphemy. What do you think? They all condemned him as worthy of death.

65 Some of them started spitting at him. They blindfolded his eyes, then hit him, saying, "Who hit you? Prophecy!" The guards, punching and slapping, took him away.

65 Then some began to spit at him; they blindfolded him, struck him with their fists, and said, "Prophecy!" And the guards took him and beat him.

66 While all this was going on, Peter was down in the courtyard. One of the Chief Priest's servant girls came in

66 While Peter was below in the courtyard, one of the servant girls of the high priest came by.

67 and, seeing Peter warming himself there, looked hard at him and said, "You were with the Nazarene, Jesus."

- 67 When she saw Peter warming himself, she looked closely at him. "You also were with that Nazarene, Jesus," she said.
- 68 He denied it: "I don't know what you're talking about." He went out on the porch. A rooster crowed.
- 68 But he denied it. "I don't know or understand what you're talking about," he said, and went out into the entryway.
- 69 The girl spotted him and began telling the people standing around, "He's one of them."
- 69 When the servant girl saw him there, she said again to those standing around, "This fellow is one of them."
- 70 He denied it again. After a little while, the bystanders brought it up again. "You've got to be one of them. You've got 'Galilean' written all over you."
- 70 Again he denied it. After a little while, those standing near said to Peter, "Surely you are one of them, for you are a Galilean."
- 71 Now Peter got really nervous and swore, "I never laid eyes on this man you're talking about."
- 71 He began to call down curses on himself, and he swore to them, "I don't know this man you're talking about."
- 72 Just then the rooster crowed a second time. Peter remembered how Jesus had said, "Before a rooster crows twice, you'll deny me three times." He collapsed in tears.
- 72 Immediately the rooster crowed the second time. Then Peter remembered the word Jesus had spoken to him: "Before the rooster crows twice you will disown me three times." And he broke down and wept.

Mark 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 At dawn's first light, the high priests, with the religious leaders and scholars, arranged a conference with the entire Jewish Council. After tying Jesus securely, they took him out and presented him to Pilate.
- 1 Very early in the morning, the chief priests, with the elders, the teachers of the law and the whole Sanhedrin, reached a decision. They bound

- Jesus, led him away and handed him over to Pilate.
- 2 Pilate asked him, "Are you the 'King of the Jews'?" He answered, "If you say so."
- 2 Are you the king of the Jews? asked Pilate. "Yes, it is as you say," Jesus replied.
- 3 The high priests let loose a barrage of accusations.
- 3 The chief priests accused him of many things.
- 4 Pilate asked again, "Aren't you going to answer anything? That's quite a list of accusations."
- 4 So again Pilate asked him, "Aren't you going to answer? See how many things they are accusing you of."
- 5 Still, he said nothing. Pilate was impressed, really impressed.
- 5 But Jesus still made no reply, and Pilate was amazed.
- 6 It was a custom at the Feast to release a prisoner, anyone the people asked for.
- 6 Now it was the custom at the Feast to release a prisoner whom the people requested.
- 7 There was one prisoner called Barabbas, locked up with the insurrectionists who had committed murder during the uprising against Rome.
- 7 A man called Barabbas was in prison with the insurrectionists who had committed murder in the uprising.
- 8 As the crowd came up and began to present its petition for him to release a prisoner,
- 8 The crowd came up and asked Pilate to do for them what he usually did.
- 9 Pilate anticipated them: "Do you want me to release the King of the Jews to you?"
- 9 Do you want me to release to you the king of the Jews? asked Pilate,
- 10 Pilate knew by this time that it was through sheer spite that the high priests had turned Jesus over to him.
- 10 knowing it was out of envy that the chief priests had handed Jesus over to him.
- 11 But the high priests by then had worked up the crowd to ask for the release of Barabbas.
- 11 But the chief priests stirred up the crowd to have Pilate release Barabbas instead.

- 12 Pilate came back, "So what do I do with this man you call King of the Jews?"
- 12 What shall I do, then, with the one you call the king of the Jews? Pilate asked them.
- 13 They yelled, "Nail him to a cross!"
- 13 Crucify him! they shouted.
- 14 Pilate objected, "But for what crime?" But they yelled all the louder, "Nail him to a cross!"
- 14 Why? What crime has he committed? asked Pilate. But they shouted all the louder, "Crucify him!"
- 15 Pilate gave the crowd what it wanted, set Barabbas free and turned Jesus over for whipping and crucifixion.
- 15 Wanting to satisfy the crowd, Pilate released Barabbas to them. He had Jesus flogged, and handed him over to be crucified.
- 16 The soldiers took Jesus into the palace (called Praetorium) and called together the entire brigade.
- 16 The soldiers led Jesus away into the palace (that is, the Praetorium) and called together the whole company of soldiers.
- 17 They dressed him up in purple and put a crown plaited from a thorn bush on his head.
- 17 They put a purple robe on him, then twisted together a crown of thorns and set it on him.
- 18 Then they began their mockery: "Bravo, King of the Jews!"
- 18 And they began to call out to him, "Hail, king of the Jews!"
- 19 They banged on his head with a club, spit on him, and knelt down in mock worship.
- 19 Again and again they struck him on the head with a staff and spit on him. Falling on their knees, they paid homage to him.
- 20 After they had had their fun, they took off the purple cape and put his own clothes back on him. Then they marched out to nail him to the cross.
- 20 And when they had mocked him, they took off the purple robe and put his own clothes on him. Then they led him out to crucify him.
- 21 There was a man walking by, coming from work, Simon from Cyrene, the father of Alexander and Rufus. They made him carry Jesus' cross.

- 21 A certain man from Cyrene, Simon, the father of Alexander and Rufus, was passing by on his way in from the country, and they forced him to carry the cross.
- 22 The soldiers brought Jesus to Golgotha, meaning "Skull Hill."
- 22 They brought Jesus to the place called Golgotha (which means The Place of the Skull).
- 23 They offered him a mild painkiller (wine mixed with myrrh), but he wouldn't take it.
- 23 Then they offered him wine mixed with myrrh, but he did not take it.
- 24 And they nailed him to the cross. They divided up his clothes and threw dice to see who would get them.
- 24 And they crucified him. Dividing up his clothes, they cast lots to see what each would get.
- 25 They nailed him up at nine o'clock in the morning.
- 25 It was the third hour when they crucified him.
- 26 The charge against him--THE KING OF THE JEWS--was printed on a poster.
- 26 The written notice of the charge against him read: THE KING OF THE JEWS.
- 27 Along with him, they crucified two criminals, one to his right, the other to his left.
- 27 They crucified two robbers with him, one on his right and one on his left.
- 28 (OMITTED TEXT)
- 29 People passing along the road jeered, shaking their heads in mock lament: "You bragged that you could tear down the Temple and then rebuild it in three days--
- 29 Those who passed by hurled insults at him, shaking their heads and saying, "So! You who are going to destroy the temple and build it in three days,
- 30 so show us your stuff! Save yourself! If you're really God's Son, come down from that cross!"
- 30 come down from the cross and save yourself!"
- 31 The high priests, along with the religion scholars, were right there mixing it up with the rest of them, having a great time poking fun at him:

"He saved others--but he can't save himself!

31 In the same way the chief priests and the teachers of the law mocked him among themselves. "He saved others," they said, "but he can't save himself!

32 Messiah, is he? King of Israel? Then let him climb down from that cross. We'll all become believers then!" Even the men crucified alongside him joined in the mockery.

32 Let this Christ, this King of Israel, come down now from the cross, that we may see and believe." Those crucified with him also heaped insults on him.

33 At noon the sky became extremely dark.

33 At the sixth hour darkness came over the whole land until the ninth hour.

34 The darkness lasted three hours. At three o'clock, Jesus groaned out of the depths, crying loudly, "Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani?" which means, "My God, my God, why have you abandoned me?"

34 And at the ninth hour Jesus cried out in a loud voice, "Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani?"--which means, "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?"

35 Some of the bystanders who heard him said, "Listen, he's calling for Elijah."

35 When some of those standing near heard this, they said, "Listen, he's calling Elijah."

36 Someone ran off, soaked a sponge in sour wine, put it on a stick, and gave it to him to drink, saying, "Let's see if Elijah comes to take him down."

36 One man ran, filled a sponge with wine vinegar, put it on a stick, and offered it to Jesus to drink. "Now leave him alone. Let's see if Elijah comes to take him down," he said.

37 But Jesus, with a loud cry, gave his last breath.

37 With a loud cry, Jesus breathed his last.

38 At that moment the Temple curtain ripped right down the middle.

38 The curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom.

39 When the Roman captain standing guard in front of him saw that he had quit breathing, he said, "This has to be the Son of God!"

- 39 And when the centurion, who stood there in front of Jesus, heard his cry and saw how he died, he said, "Surely this man was the Son of God!"
- 40 There were women watching from a distance, among them Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of the younger James and Joses, and Salome.
- 40 Some women were watching from a distance. Among them were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James the younger and of Joses, and Salome.
- 41 When Jesus was in Galilee, these women followed and served him, and had come up with him to Jerusalem.
- 41 In Galilee these women had followed him and cared for his needs. Many other women who had come up with him to Jerusalem were also there.
- 42 Late in the afternoon, since it was the Day of Preparation (that is, Sabbath eve),
- 42 It was Preparation Day (that is, the day before the Sabbath). So as evening approached,
- 43 Joseph of Arimathea, a highly respected member of the Jewish Council, came. He was one who lived expectantly, on the lookout for the kingdom of God. Working up his courage, he went to Pilate and asked for Jesus' body.
- 43 Joseph of Arimathea, a prominent member of the Council, who was himself waiting for the kingdom of God, went boldly to Pilate and asked for Jesus' body.
- 44 Pilate questioned whether he could be dead that soon and called for the captain to verify that he was really dead.
- 44 Pilate was surprised to hear that he was already dead. Summoning the centurion, he asked him if Jesus had already died.
- 45 Assured by the captain, he gave Joseph the corpse.
- 45 When he learned from the centurion that it was so, he gave the body to Joseph.
- 46 Having already purchased a linen shroud, Joseph took him down, wrapped him in the shroud, placed him in a tomb that had been cut into the rock, and rolled a large stone across the opening.
- 46 So Joseph bought some linen cloth, took down the body, wrapped it in the linen, and placed it in a tomb cut out of rock. Then he rolled a stone

against the entrance of the tomb.

47 Mary Magdalene and Mary, mother of Joses, watched the burial.

47 Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of Joses saw where he was laid.

Mark 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 When the Sabbath was over, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices so they could embalm him.
- 1 When the Sabbath was over, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices so that they might go to anoint Jesus' body.
- 2 Very early on Sunday morning, as the sun rose, they went to the tomb.
- 2 Very early on the first day of the week, just after sunrise, they were on their way to the tomb
- 3 They worried out loud to each other, "Who will roll back the stone from the tomb for us?"
- 3 and they asked each other, "Who will roll the stone away from the entrance of the tomb?"
- 4 Then they looked up, saw that it had been rolled back--it was a huge stone--and walked right in.
- 4 But when they looked up, they saw that the stone, which was very large, had been rolled away.
- 5 They saw a young man sitting on the right side, dressed all in white. They were completely taken aback, astonished.
- 5 As they entered the tomb, they saw a young man dressed in a white robe sitting on the right side, and they were alarmed.
- 6 He said, "Don't be afraid. I know you're looking for Jesus the Nazarene, the One they nailed on the cross. He's been raised up; he's here no longer. You can see for yourselves that the place is empty.
- 6 Don't be alarmed, he said. "You are looking for Jesus the Nazarene, who was crucified. He has risen! He is not here. See the place where they laid him.
- 7 Now--on your way. Tell his disciples and Peter that he is going on ahead of you to Galilee. You'll see him there, exactly as he said."

- 7 But go, tell his disciples and Peter, 'He is going ahead of you into Galilee. There you will see him, just as he told you.' "
- 8 They got out as fast as they could, beside themselves, their heads swimming. Stunned, they said nothing to anyone.
- 8 Trembling and bewildered, the women went out and fled from the tomb. They said nothing to anyone, because they were afraid.
- 9 [After rising from the dead, Jesus appeared early on Sunday morning to Mary Magdalene, whom he had delivered from seven demons.
- 9 When Jesus rose early on the first day of the week, he appeared first to Mary Magdalene, out of whom he had driven seven demons.
- 10 She went to his former companions, now weeping and carrying on, and told them.
- 10 She went and told those who had been with him and who were mourning and weeping.
- 11 When they heard her report that she had seen him alive and well, they didn't believe her.
- 11 When they heard that Jesus was alive and that she had seen him, they did not believe it.
- 12 Later he appeared, but in a different form, to two of them out walking in the countryside.
- 12 Afterward Jesus appeared in a different form to two of them while they were walking in the country.
- 13 They went back and told the rest, but they weren't believed either.
- 13 These returned and reported it to the rest; but they did not believe them either.
- 14 Still later, as the Eleven were eating supper, he appeared and took them to task most severely for their stubborn unbelief, refusing to believe those who had seen him raised up.
- 14 Later Jesus appeared to the Eleven as they were eating; he rebuked them for their lack of faith and their stubborn refusal to believe those who had seen him after he had risen.
- 15 Then he said, "Go into the world. Go everywhere and announce the Message of God's good news to one and all.
- 15 He said to them, "Go into all the world and preach the good news to all creation.

- 16 Whoever believes and is baptized is saved; whoever refuses to believe is damned.
- 16 Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved, but whoever does not believe will be condemned.
- 17 "These are some of the signs that will accompany believers: They will throw out demons in my name, they will speak in new tongues,
- 17 And these signs will accompany those who believe: In my name they will drive out demons; they will speak in new tongues;
- 18 they will take snakes in their hands, they will drink poison and not be hurt, they will lay hands on the sick and make them well."
- 18 they will pick up snakes with their hands; and when they drink deadly poison, it will not hurt them at all; they will place their hands on sick people, and they will get well."
- 19 Then the Master Jesus, after briefing them, was taken up to heaven, and he sat down beside God in the place of honor.
- 19 After the Lord Jesus had spoken to them, he was taken up into heaven and he sat at the right hand of God.
- 20 And the disciples went everywhere preaching, the Master working right with them, validating the Message with indisputable evidence.]
- 20 Then the disciples went out and preached everywhere, and the Lord worked with them and confirmed his word by the signs that accompanied it.